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May 2024 | Poll Finding

KFF Health Tracking Poll May 2024: Voters' Views of Health Policy Issues in Context of Presidential Campaigns

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Former President Donald Trump and President Joe Biden are now the presumptive nominees for the Republican and Democratic parties, and their respective records as president and their campaign platforms suggest very different visions for the future of U.S. health care. This new KFF Health Tracking Poll looks at voters' views of some of the country's major health and entitlement programs and how these views line up with the candidates' approaches to these issues based on their track records, policy positions, and statements on the campaign trail. While previous polls show that many other issues outrank health care on voters' minds this election cycle (and issues are only one part of how voters make decisions), these findings help illustrate how voters may react to talking points about health care that the candidates may make during the course of the campaign.

Key Takeaways

- Six months out from the 2024 presidential election, partisans predictably put more trust in their own party's candidate on health issues, but President Biden has a clear trust advantage over former President Trump with independent voters, a key voting group, on many areas of health care. For example, when it comes to addressing high health care costs, an issue that rises to the top of many voters' priority lists, while neither candidate has a majority of trust among independent voters, Biden has an advantage over Trump (39% v. 26%), with 34% of independent voters saying they trust neither candidate on this issue.
- Most voters overall are still unaware of the Medicare drug pricing provisions in the Inflation Reduction Act (IRA) that President Biden signed into law, but awareness is higher and has increased since November among older voters and among Biden's base of Democratic voters. Large shares of voters across partisan groups also support Biden's proposals to extend some of the IRA's drug provisions to cover all adults with private insurance, including capping monthly costs for insulin and placing a limit on out-of-pocket prescription drug costs. Voters are also supportive of expanding the Medicare prescription drug price negotiation of the IRA to cover a larger number of drugs, with three-quarters saying more drugs should be subject to price negotiations, including majorities across partisanship.
- While most voters are supportive of the proposals President Biden has made for addressing prescription drug costs, most are pessimistic about what either candidate would accomplish in this area if elected. Among independent voters, Biden has a slight edge, with half saying it is

likely that his administration's policies will lower prescription drug costs if he is elected, compared to about four in ten who say the same about Trump.

- Regarding abortion policy, a key voting issue for Democratic and younger voters in this election, a majority of voters (62%) support guaranteeing a federal right to abortion while fewer (42%) support leaving it up to individual states to decide the legality of abortion. Majorities of Democratic voters and stronghold Democratic groups such as young voters and Black voters are supportive of a federal guarantee, while a majority of Republican voters support leaving the legality of abortion up to individual states. Notably, support among Democratic voters for a federal guarantee (89%) is higher than support among Republican voters for leaving abortion policy up to the states (60%).
- When it comes to determining the future of the nation's major entitlement programs – Social Security, Medicare, and Medicaid – older voters give a clear advantage to President Biden. Majorities of voters are worried that, in the future, people covered by Medicare, Social Security, and Medicaid won't be able to get the same level of benefits that are available today, and many also agree that fraud, waste, and abuse are problems in these programs, which is a criticism that former President Trump has made. For context, most voters also see fraud, waste, and abuse as a major problem in private health insurance plans.
- Asked about the future of Medicaid, seven in ten voters want Medicaid to largely continue as it is today, while three in ten support changing Medicaid to cap federal funding and give states greater flexibility in designing their programs (a recurrent Republican proposal sometimes referred to as a Medicaid block grant). While large shares of Democratic and independent voters prefer to keep Medicaid as it is today, Republican voters are evenly divided, with about half preferring to keep Medicaid as is and half supporting a cap on federal spending.
- While a majority of voters have favorable views of the ACA, attitudes towards the law overall continue to be marked by partisanship. One-third of Republican voters now view the law favorably (up from 11% when the law was passed), but three-quarters of Republican voters say they would support "repealing and replacing" the ACA. Previous polling and past repeal efforts have shown that public support for repeal erodes considerably when popular provisions like the protections for people with pre-existing conditions are put at risk, so while these views don't necessarily imply enduring support for repealing the ACA, they do suggest there is some receptivity among Republican voters for "repeal and replace" as a talking point. Notably, about four in ten Republican voters think Trump will try to repeal the entire ACA if elected, compared to two-thirds of Democratic voters.
- Despite divided views on the ACA overall, there is majority support for strengthening one key piece of the ACA: about seven in ten voters – including majorities across partisanship – support extending enhanced financial assistance for people who purchase health coverage through the ACA marketplace. Currently, enhanced subsidies that were provided in recent years are set to expire at the end of 2025.

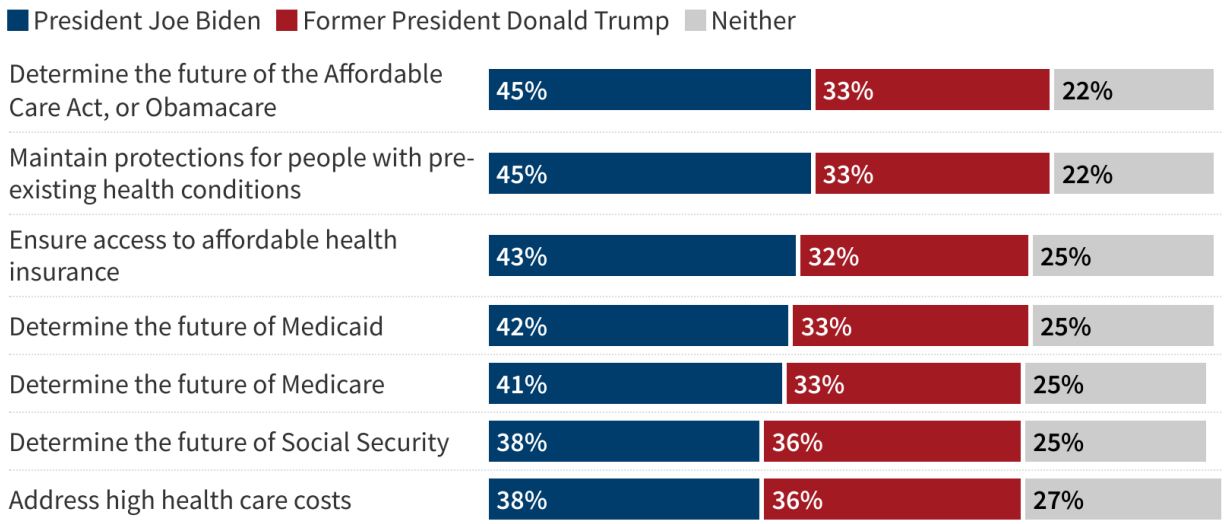
Biden Has Trust Advantage On Many Areas of Health Care, But Trump Ties On Addressing High Costs

When it comes to trust of the presumptive 2024 presidential candidates, larger shares of voters trust President Joe Biden than former President Donald Trump on several key health care policy issues, but neither candidate has a clear lead when it comes to addressing high health care costs, with similar shares of voters saying they trust Biden (38%) and Trump (36%).

Figure 1

Voters Trust Biden More than Trump on a Variety of Health Care Policy Measures, but Are Split When It Comes to Social Security and Addressing Health Care Costs

Which candidate for president do you trust more to do each of the following?



Note: Among registered voters. See topline for full question wording.
Source: KFF Health Tracking Poll (April 23-May 1, 2024)

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Not surprisingly, voters are split along party lines in their trust of the presumptive candidates on health care issues, with Democrats largely trusting Biden over Trump and Republicans trusting Trump over Biden. Still, even among partisans, substantial shares say they trust “neither” candidate on some health care issues. For example, about one in five Democratic voters and Republican voters say they trust “neither” candidate to address high health care costs.

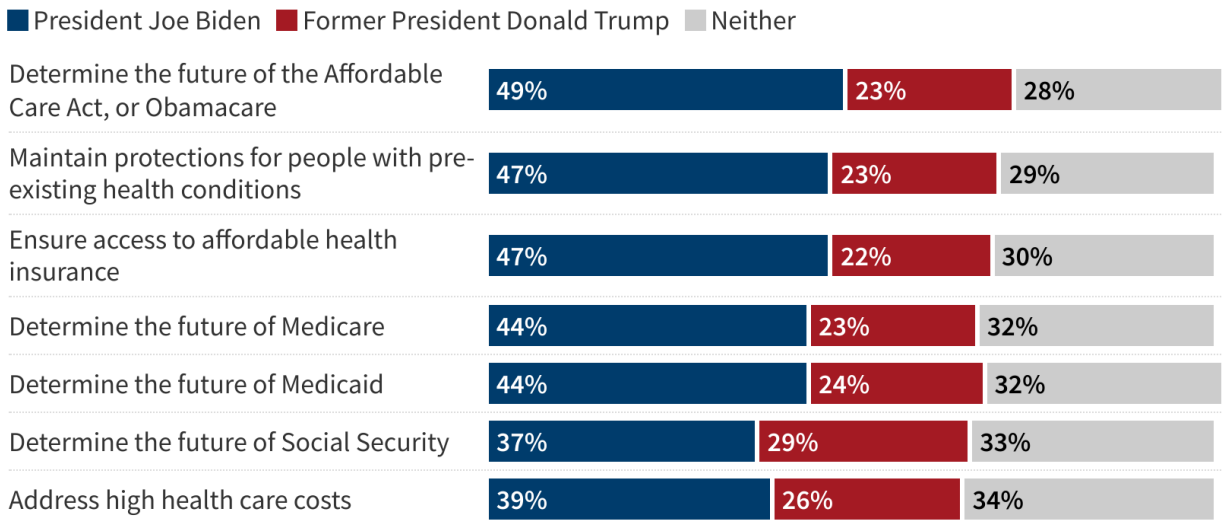
Independent voters are more likely to say they trust Biden more than Trump in each are of health care, including addressing care costs. Biden has a notable trust lead among independent voters when it comes to determining the future of the ACA (49% v. 23%), ensuring access to affordable health insurance (47% v. 22%), and maintaining protections for people with pre-existing health conditions (47% v. 23%) and a substantial lead on determining the future of Medicare (44% v. 23%) and Medicaid (44% v. 24%). When it

comes to addressing high health care costs, independent voters give the edge to Biden, with four in ten (39%) saying they trust him more compared to a quarter (26%) for Trump. However, a third (34%) of independent voters say they don't trust either candidate.

Figure 2

Among Independent Voters, Biden Leads Trump in Trust on Health Issues, but About Three in Ten Trust Neither Candidate

Among independent voters: Which candidate for president do you trust more to do each of the following?



Note: Among registered voters who identify as independents. See topline for full question wording.
Source: KFF Health Tracking Poll (April 23-May 1, 2024)

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Voters' Views in Key Health Policy Areas

Prescription Drug Prices

Lowering prescription drug prices has been a frequent talking point of both President Biden and former President Trump. While Trump kept drug prices on the political agenda during his time as president, his administration ultimately did little to contain them. President Biden has touted passage of the Inflation Reduction Act (IRA), including its provisions aimed at lowering prescription drug prices for people with Medicare, as one of the signature achievements of his administration.

Most voters overall are unaware of the Medicare drug pricing provisions in the IRA, but awareness is higher among older voters and among Biden's base of voters who identify as Democrats. Overall, about a third of voters correctly say there is a federal law in place that requires the federal government to negotiate the price of some prescription drugs for people with Medicare (36%) or one that caps the cost of insulin for people with Medicare (35%), while about a quarter (27%) know there is a law that limits annual

out-of-pocket prescription drug costs for people with Medicare and one in seven (14%) know there is a law that penalizes drug companies for increasing prices for Medicare faster than the rate of inflation.

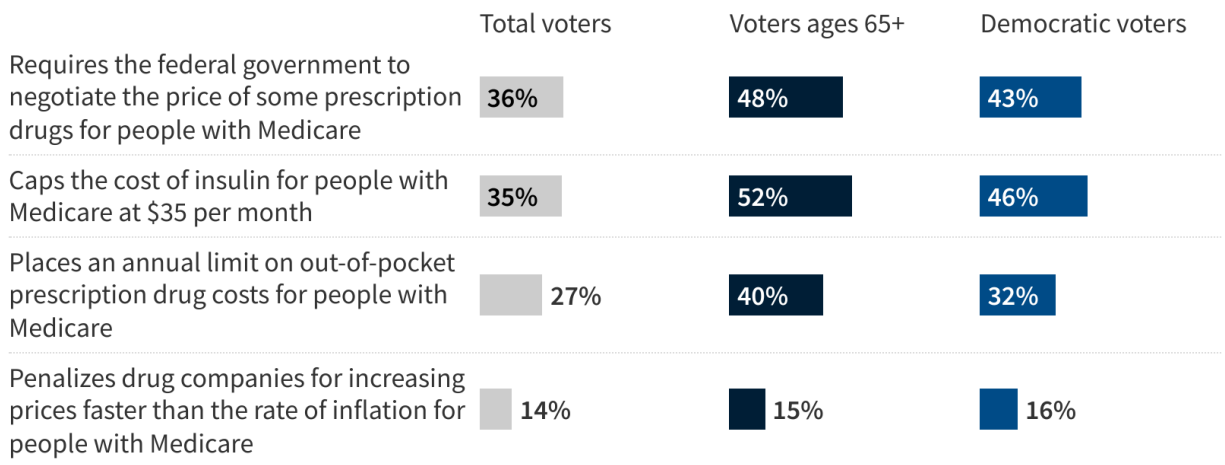
Awareness of these provisions is higher among voters ages 65 and older – a group that is mostly covered by Medicare and tends to vote at higher rates than younger adults. About half (52%) of older voters are aware of the IRA's $35 cap on insulin for people with Medicare and a similar share (48%) correctly identify that there is a law that requires the federal government to negotiate the price of prescription drugs for Medicare enrollees.

Across partisans, fewer than half of Democrats, independents, and Republican voters are aware of any of these health care provisions. However, Democratic voters are more likely than Republican voters to correctly say there is a law that caps the cost of insulin for people with Medicare at $35 per month (46% v. 28%) or requires the federal government to negotiate the price of some prescription drugs for people with Medicare (43% v. 32%).

Figure 3

Few Voters Are Aware of IRA Drug Pricing Provisions, but Awareness Is Higher Among Older Voters and Democrats

Percent who say, as far as they know, there is a federal law in place that does each of the following:



Note: Among registered voters. See topline for full question wording.
Source: KFF Health Tracking Poll (April 23-May 1, 2024)

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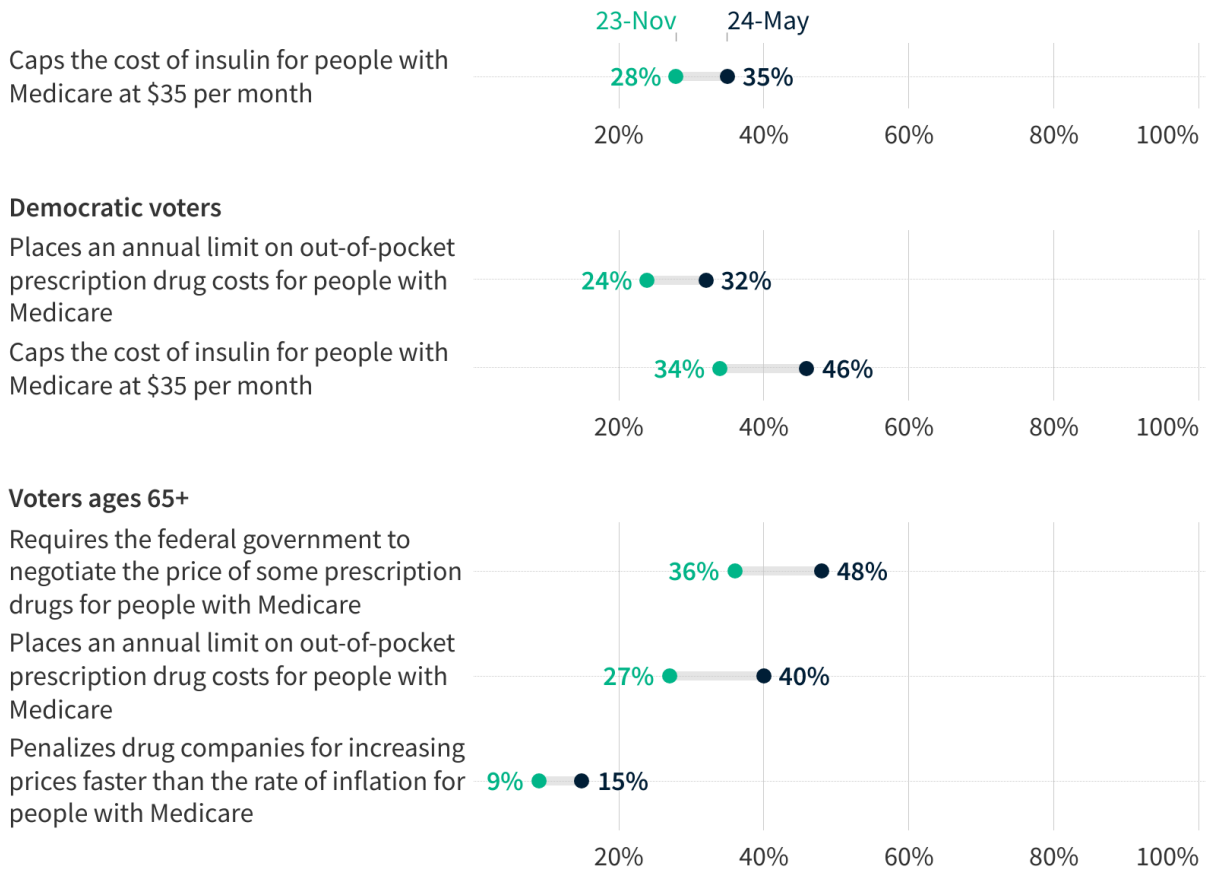
Voter awareness of the IRA's $35 insulin cap for people with Medicare has increased by about seven percentage points since November 2023 when about a quarter (28%) of voters were aware of this provision of the IRA. Awareness of the IRA's other Medicare drug pricing provisions has not changed significantly among all voters since November, but there have been increases in awareness of some provisions among Democratic voters and older voters, suggesting that Biden's campaigning on the successes of the IRA may be breaking through with some groups.

Among Democratic voters, between November 2023 and May 2024 there was a 12 percentage point increase in the share correctly identify the cap on insulin (from 34% to 46%) and an 8 percentage point uptick in awareness of the law placing limits on out-of-pocket prescription drug costs for people with Medicare (from 24% to 32%). Similarly, among voters ages 65 and older, the share who are aware there is a federal law that limits annual out-of-pocket prescription drug costs for people with Medicare increased from 27% to 40% between November and May, the share who are aware of the negotiation provision increased from 36% to 48%, and the share who are aware there is a law that penalizes drug companies for increasing prices faster than the rate of inflation for people with Medicare from 9% to 15%.

Figure 4

Among Older and Democratic Voters, Voter Awareness of IRA Provisions Has Increased Since November 2023

Percent who say, as far as they know, there is a federal law in place that does each of the following:



Note: Among registered voters. See topline for full question wording.

Source: KFF Health Tracking Poll (October 31-November 7, 2023 and April 23-May 1, 2024)

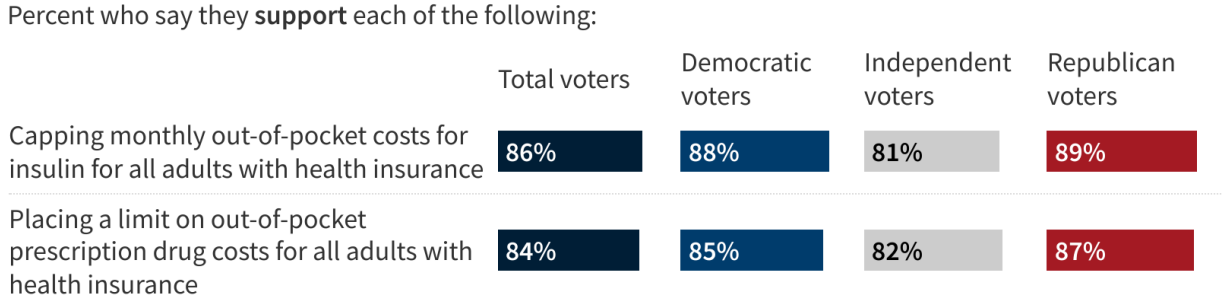
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President Biden has expressed support for several policies that would extend some of the prescription drug provisions of the IRA to cover all adults with private insurance. The KFF Health Tracking Poll finds that large shares of voters support these proposals, including capping monthly out-of-pocket costs for insulin for all adults with health insurance (86%) and placing a limit on out-of-pocket prescription drug costs for all adults with health insurance (84%).

Large majorities across partisans support both drug pricing provisions, including nearly nine in ten Democratic voters (88%) and Republican voters (89%) who support capping out-of-pocket costs for insulin and similar shares who support placing an out-of-pocket limit on prescription drug costs (85% of Democrats and 87% of Republicans).

Figure 5

Majorities Across Partisans Support Extending Some Medicare Drug Pricing Provisions of the IRA to Cover All Insured Adults



Note: Among registered voters. See topline for full question wording.
Source: KFF Health Tracking Poll (April 23-May 1, 2024)

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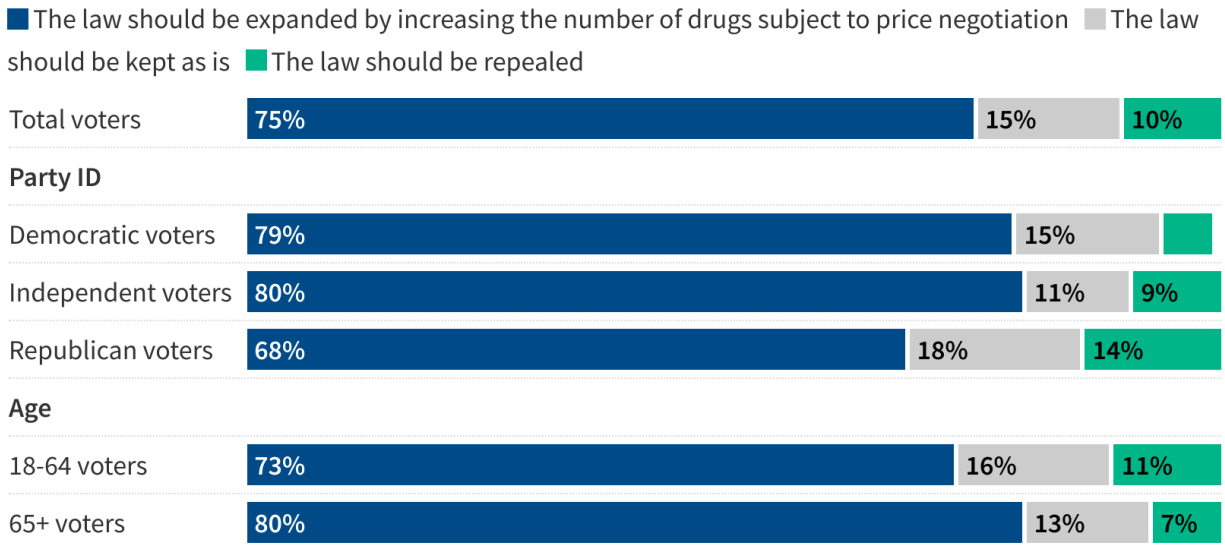
Voters are also supportive of expanding the Medicare prescription drug price negotiation of the IRA to cover a larger number of drugs. Under the law, negotiated prices will take effect for 10 prescription drugs in 2026, increasing to a total of 60 drugs by 2029. Three-quarters (75%) of voters say the law should be expanded by increasing the number of drugs subject to price negotiation. Another 15% think the law should be kept as is, while one in ten (10%) voters want the law to be repealed.

Among the biggest proponents for expansion of the drug price negotiation aspect of Medicare are those ages 65 and older (80% want the law to be expanded) and Democratic (79%) and independent (80%) voters. However, a majority of Republicans (68%) also agree that the law should be expanded.

Figure 6

Majorities of Voters Support Increasing Number of Drugs Subject to Price Negotiation Under Medicare

As you may know, a law was passed in 2022 that requires the federal government to negotiate the price of some prescription drugs for people with Medicare. Under this law, negotiated prices will take effect for 10 prescription drugs in 2026, increasing to a total of 60 drugs by 2029. Which comes closer to your view?



Note: Among registered voters. See topline for full question wording.
Source: KFF Health Tracking Poll (April 23-May 1, 2024)

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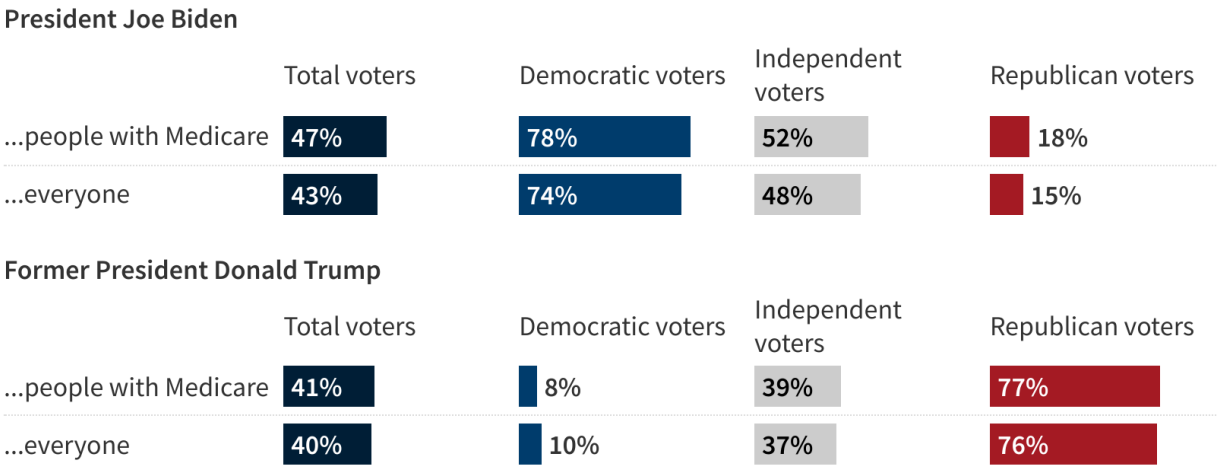
While most voters are supportive of the proposals President Biden has made for addressing prescription drug costs, most are pessimistic about what either candidate would accomplish in this area if elected, with fewer than half saying it is “very” or “somewhat” likely that Biden’s policies would lower prescription drug costs for people on Medicare (47%) or for everyone (43%) if he were re-elected. About four in ten voters say the same about former President Trump (41% for people with Medicare, 40% for everyone).

Not surprisingly, majorities of partisans say they think it is likely their party’s respective candidate will lower drug costs if elected, while few say the same about the other party’s candidate. Among independent voters, about half think it is likely that Biden’s policies would lower prescription drug costs for people with Medicare (52%) or for everyone (48%), while slightly fewer say the same about Trump (39% and 37%, respectively).

Figure 7

Most Voters Are Pessimistic About Biden or Trump's Policies Lowering Drug Costs, but Independent Voters Give Biden Slight Advantage

Percent who say it is **very** or **somewhat likely** that if elected, each of the following's administration will lower prescription drugs costs for:



Note: Among registered voters. See topline for full question wording.
Source: KFF Health Tracking Poll (April 23-May 1, 2024)

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Abortion Policy

The March KFF Health Tracking Poll provided an extensive look at voters' views of abortion and the role it may play in the upcoming election. In this poll we examine voter support for two approaches to abortion policy for which President Biden and former President Trump have voiced support. President Biden has expressed support for a federal right to abortion while former President Donald Trump has stated that abortion policies should be left to the states. When it comes to abortion policy – a key voting issue for Democratic and younger voters in this election – a majority of voters (62%) support guaranteeing a federal right to abortion while fewer (42%) support leaving it up to individual states to decide the legality of abortion[1].

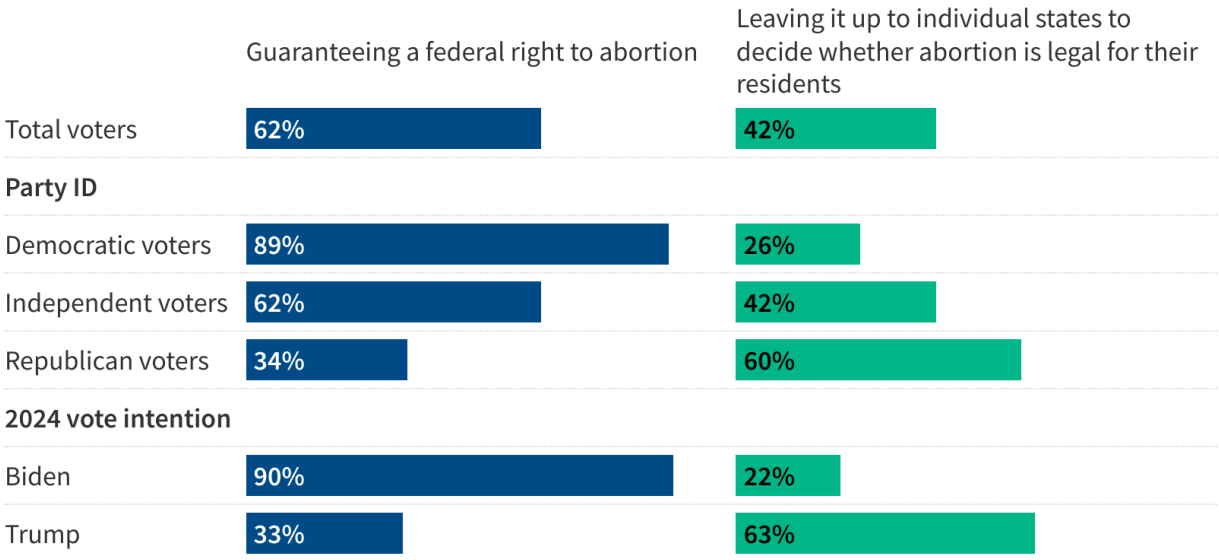
About nine in ten (89%) Democratic voters support guaranteeing a federal right to abortion compared to about six in ten independent voters (62%) and one-third of Republican voters (34%). Conversely, about six in ten Republican voters support leaving abortion up to individual states compared to 42% of independent voters and a quarter (26%) of Democratic voters.

Those who plan on voting for Biden in 2024 (90%), Democrats (89%), young voters ages 18-29 (79%), and Black voters (78%) are among the largest groups in support of guaranteeing a federal right to abortion. Majorities of those who plan to vote for Trump in 2024 (63%) and Republican voters (60%), support leaving abortion up to individual states.

Figure 8

Nine in Ten Democratic Voters Support Guaranteeing a Federal Right to Abortion, While Six in Ten Republican Voters Support Leaving Abortion Policy Up to States

Percent who say they support each of the following:



Note: Among registered voters. These were two separate items on a support or oppose list, not two separate answer choices to a single question. See topline for full question wording.

Source: KFF Health Tracking Poll (April 23-May 1, 2024)

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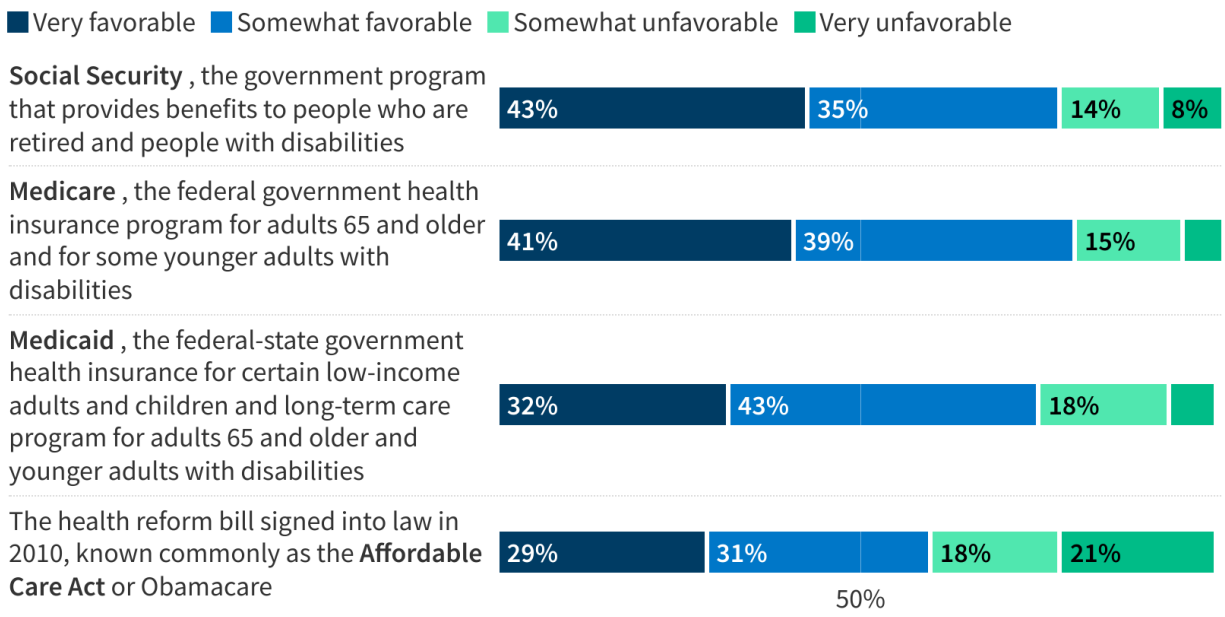
Health and Entitlement Programs

Besides issues of prescription drugs prices for Medicare, there are signs that Trump and Biden would approach the future of the nation's major health and entitlement programs differently if elected. Majorities of voters have a favorable opinion of the major entitlement programs, with at least three in four voters saying they have a "very" or "somewhat" favorable opinion of Medicare (80%), Social Security (78%), and Medicaid (75%). A smaller share of voters – but still a majority -- say they have a favorable opinion of the Affordable Care Act (ACA), or Obamacare (60%). While its passage and enactment were embroiled in partisan battles, the public has consistently held a more favorable than unfavorable view of the ACA since 2018.

Figure 9

Large Majorities of Voters Have a Favorable Opinion of Entitlement Programs, with a Smaller Majority Favoring the ACA

In general, do you have a favorable or unfavorable opinion of each of the following?



Note: Among registered voters. See topline for full question wording.

Source: KFF Health Tracking Poll (April 23-May 1, 2024)

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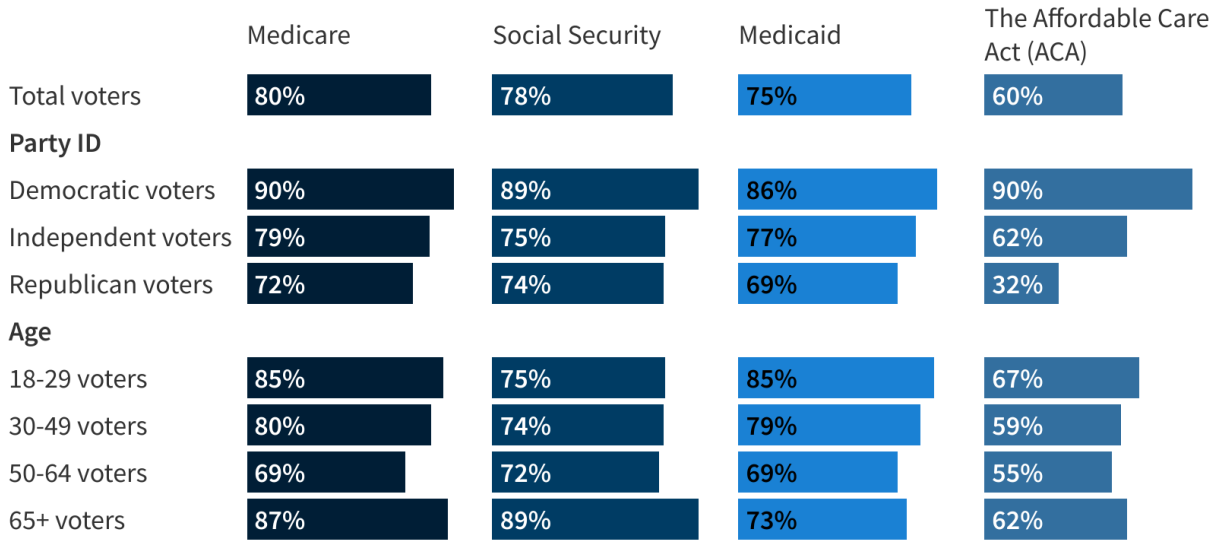
While Democratic voters are somewhat more likely than Republican voters to express favorable views of Medicare, Medicaid, and Social Security, majorities across partisans are favorable towards each of these programs. Partisan divisions are more notable when it comes to the ACA, with nine in ten Democratic voters (90%) holding favorable views of the ACA compared to a third (32%) Republican voters – a share that has increased since the law was enacted (in April 2020, just 11% of Republican voters had a favorable view of the law).

Medicare, Social Security, Medicaid, and the ACA are also popular with voters across age groups, although voters ages 65 and older are somewhat more likely than younger voters to express favorable opinions of Social Security and Medicare – programs that largely provide benefits to older adults. In turn, younger voters ages 18-29 are more likely than older voters to have a favorable opinion of Medicaid.

Figure 10

Majorities of Voters Across Partisan and Age Groups View Entitlement Programs Favorably, but Partisans Divide on ACA

Percent who say they have **very** or **somewhat** favorable views of...



Note: Among registered voters. See topline for full question wording.
Source: KFF Health Tracking Poll (April 23-May 1, 2024)

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Future of Medicare, Social Security, and Medicaid

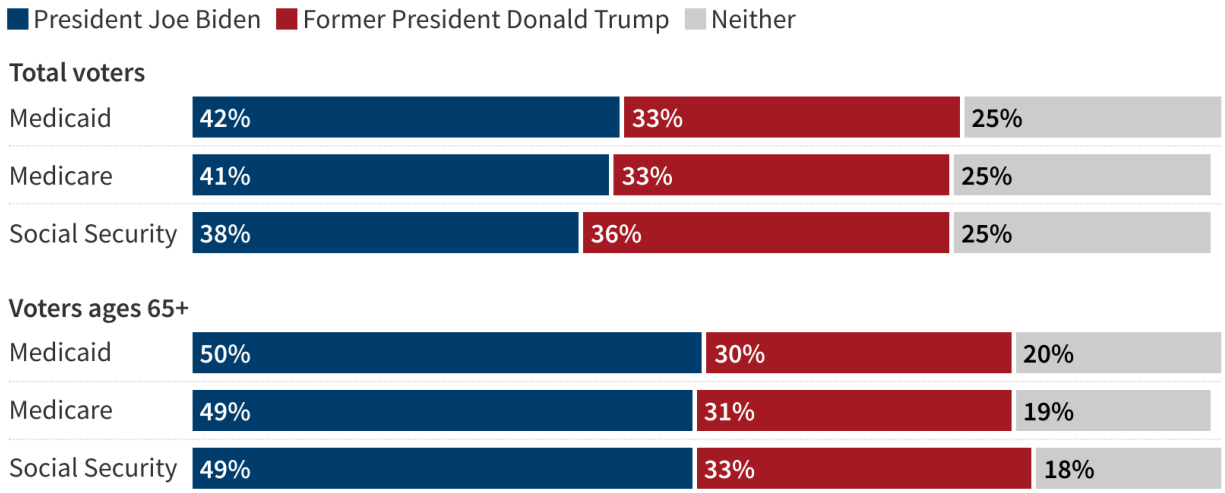
When it comes to determining the future of Social Security, Medicare, and Medicaid, neither candidate garners a clear majority of trust among voters on all three items. About four in ten voters overall say they trust President Biden more to determine the future of Medicare and Medicaid, while one-third trust former President Trump more. Voters are more evenly split on the future of Social Security, with 38% who trust Biden more and 36% for Trump.

Older voters, a key voting bloc and the primary beneficiaries of Social Security and Medicare, are more likely to trust Biden when it comes to determining the future of each program. About half of voters ages 65 and older say they trust Biden more to determine the future of Social Security (49%), Medicare (49%), and Medicaid (50%), while about a third of older voters say they trust Trump more on each.

Figure 11

Half of Voters Ages 65 and Over Trust Biden More to Determine the Future of Entitlement Programs

Which candidate for president do you trust more to determine the future of...?



Note: Among registered voters. See topline for full question wording.
Source: KFF Health Tracking Poll (April 23-May 1, 2024)

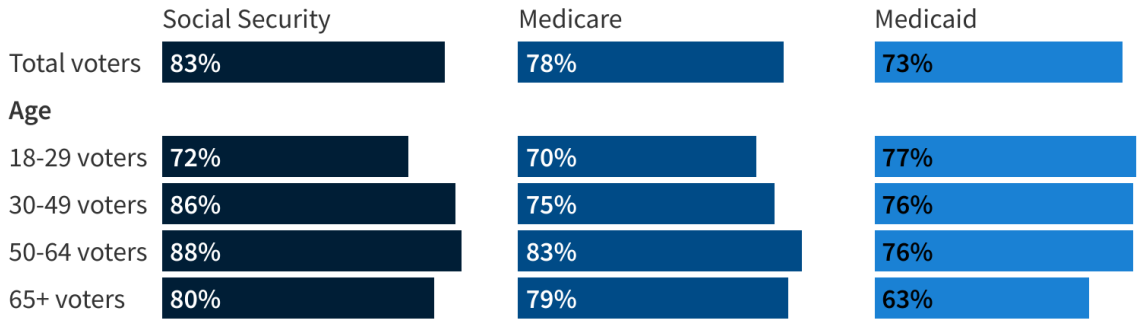
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Majorities of voters are worried that, in the future, people covered by Medicare, Social Security, and Medicaid won't be able to get the same level of benefits that are available today, with at least three in four saying they are at least somewhat worried about this when it comes to Social Security (83%), Medicare (78%), and Medicaid (73%). While large shares of voters across the age spectrum worry about future benefits available under these programs, worries about future benefits under Medicare and Social Security tend to peak among those ages 50-64, the next age group to become eligible for these programs in the coming years. A new report issued by the Medicare and Social Security trustees projects both programs will have insufficient funds to pay full benefits in about a decade.

Figure 12

Majorities of Voters Worry About Future Benefits Under Entitlement Programs, with Worries Peaking Among Those Approaching Retirement Age

Percent who say they are **very** or **somewhat worried** that in the future, people covered by each of the following will not be able to get the same level of benefits that are available to people covered today:



Note: Among registered voters. See topline for full question wording.
Source: KFF Health Tracking Poll (April 23-May 1, 2024)

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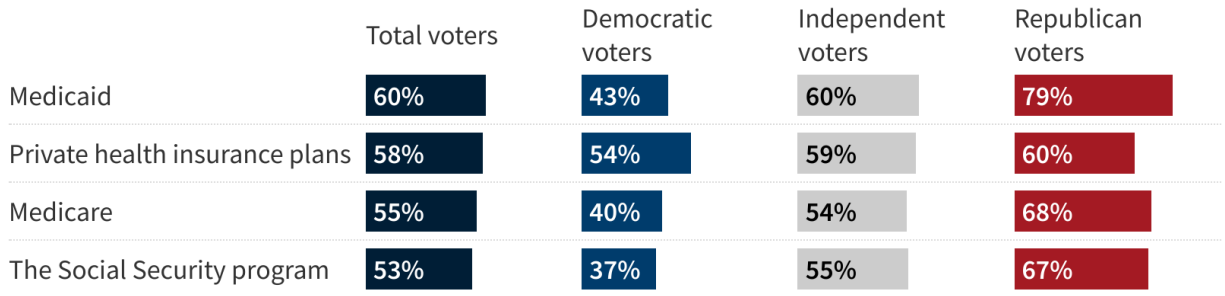
While former President Trump's remarks on the future of entitlement programs have been inconsistent, in some appearances he has criticized the Social Security and Medicare programs, stating that he will cut these programs by targeting "waste" and "fraud." Many voters agree that fraud, waste, and abuse are problems in the nation's entitlement programs, with over half saying fraud, waste, and abuse are a "major" problem in Medicaid (60%), Medicare (55%), and Social Security (53%). For context, 58% of adults also see fraud, waste, and abuse as a major problem in private health insurance.

Larger shares of Republican voters say fraud, waste, and abuse are a "major" problem in Medicare Medicaid, and Social Security than Democrats, with no differences by partisanship when it comes to concerns about private health insurance.

Figure 13

Majorities of Republican and Independent Voters Say Fraud, Waste, and Abuse Are Major Problems in Entitlement Programs, but Fewer Democratic Voters Agree

Percent who think think fraud, waste and abuse are a **major problem** in each of the following:



Note: See topline for full question wording.
Source: KFF Health Tracking Poll (April 23-May 1, 2024)

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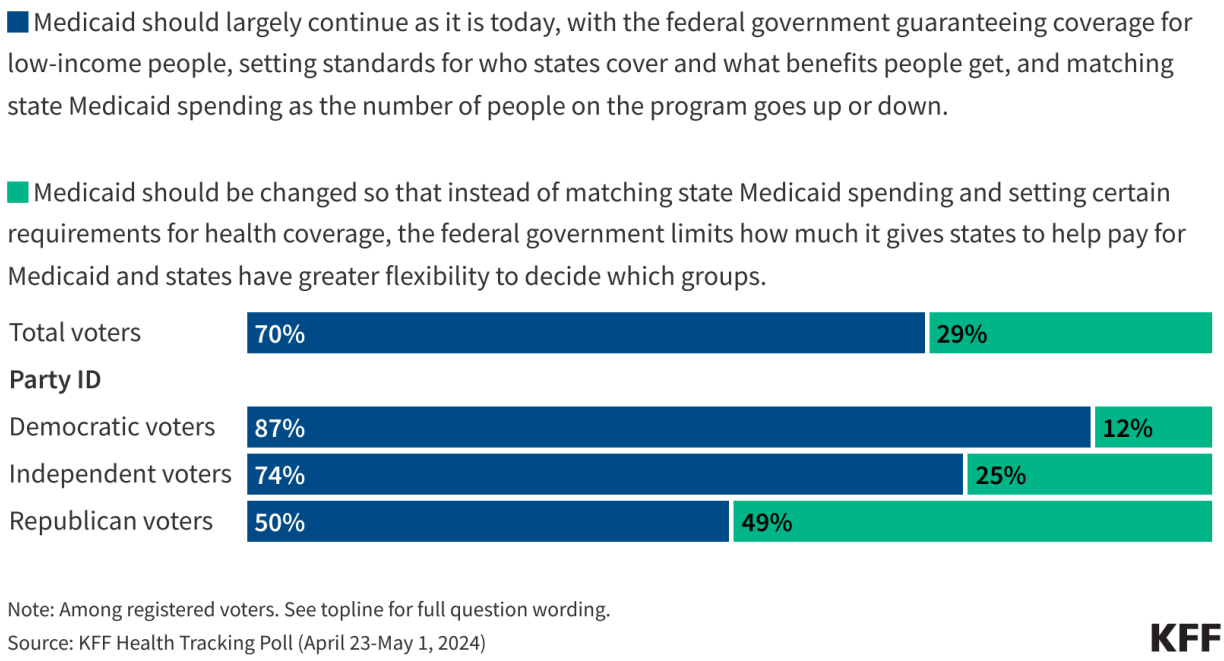
Former President Trump has not released any detailed statements on his plans for the future of Medicaid if elected, but his budget proposals as president included plans to cap federal Medicaid spending. Asked which comes closer to their view of what Medicaid should look like in the future, seven in ten voters say "Medicaid should largely continue as it is today, with the federal government guaranteeing coverage for low-income people, setting standards for who states cover and what benefits people get, and matching state Medicaid spending as the number of people on the program goes up or down." About three in ten voters (29%) say "Medicaid should be changed so that instead of matching state Medicaid spending and setting certain requirements for health coverage, the federal government limits how much it gives states to help pay for Medicaid and states have greater flexibility to decide which groups of people to cover without federal guarantees."

Majorities of voters across gender, age, and racial and ethnic groups agree that Medicaid should largely continue as it is today. However, while large shares of Democratic voters (87%) and independent voters (74%) say they want Medicaid to continue as it is today, Republican voters are evenly divided, with 50% preferring Medicaid to stay as it is today and 49% saying the federal government should limit how much it pays states and give states greater flexibility to administer their Medicaid programs.

Figure 14

Majorities of Voters Prefer To Keep Medicaid As Is, but Half of Republicans Support Changing Medicaid To Limit Federal Spending and Give States More Flexibility

Which of these two descriptions comes closer to your view of what Medicaid should look like in the future?



Note: Among registered voters. See topline for full question wording.
Source: KFF Health Tracking Poll (April 23-May 1, 2024)

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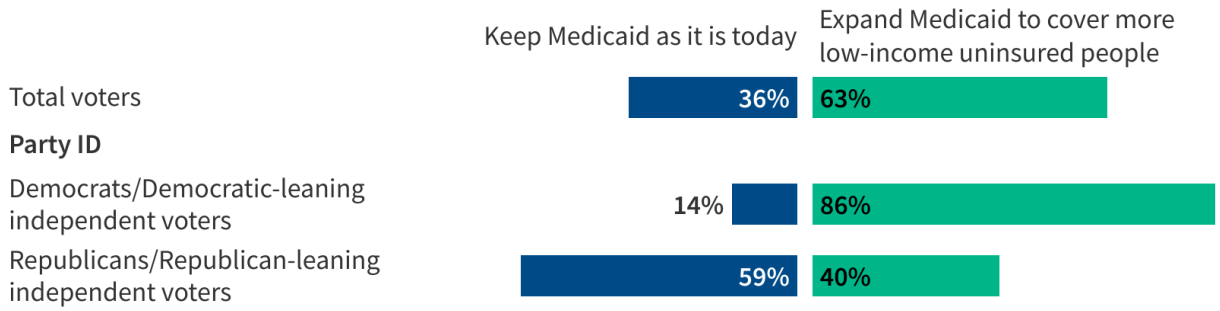
Under the ACA, most states have expanded their Medicaid programs to cover more low-income people. For states that expand their Medicaid program, the federal government pays for 90 percent of the costs of this expansion with the state paying the rest.

Two-thirds (63%) of voters who live in a non-expansion state want their state to expand Medicaid to cover more low-income uninsured people, while one-third (36%) would rather keep Medicaid as it is today. Expanding Medicaid is largely split along partisan lines, with nearly nine in ten (86%) of Democrats or Democratic-leaning independent voters who live in a state without Medicaid expansion saying they want to expand Medicaid, compared to six in ten (59%) of Republicans or Republican-leaning independent voters who want to keep Medicaid as it is today.

Figure 15

Six in Ten Voters in Non-Expansion States Think Their State Should Expand Medicaid, with Support Strongest Among Democratic Voters

Under the 2010 health care law, MOST states have expanded their Medicaid program to cover more low-income people. For states that expand their Medicaid program, the federal government pays for at least 90 percent of the costs of this expansion with the state paying the rest. Do you think your state should... ?



Note: Among voters who live in states without Medicaid expansion. See topline for full question wording.
▶ State Medicaid Expansion Details
Source: KFF Health Tracking Poll (April 23-May 1, 2024)

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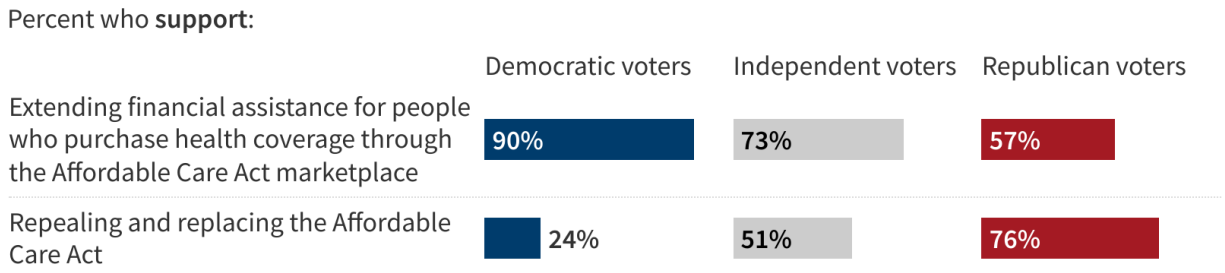
Future of the ACA

Although a majority of voters now have favorable views of the ACA, attitudes towards the law overall continue to be marked by partisanship. Three quarters of Republican voters say they would support "repealing and replacing" the ACA, as do about half of independent voters. This poll did not test other options (such as expanding or scaling back the law, which generally produce much lower levels of support for repeal). Previous polling and past repeal efforts have shown that public support for repeal erodes considerably when popular provisions like the protections for people with pre-existing conditions are put at risk, so while these views don't imply that repealing the ACA is a political reality, they do suggest there is some receptivity among Republican voters to "repeal and replace" as a talking point. Previous KFF polling has found that few voters think Trump has a plan to replace the ACA.

Aside from views on repeal, there is majority support for strengthening one key piece of the ACA: about seven in ten voters (72%) support extending financial assistance for people who purchase health coverage through the ACA marketplace, including large majorities of Democratic (90%) and independent voters (73%) and a smaller majority of Republican voters (57%). Notably, two-thirds (65%) of voters are worried that in the future, people covered by ACA marketplace insurance will not be able to get the same level of benefits that are available today.

Figure 16

Majorities Across Partisans Support Extending ACA Financial Assistance, Divided on Repealing and Replacing ACA



Note: Among registered voters. See topline for full question wording.
Source: KFF Health Tracking Poll (April 23-May 1, 2024)

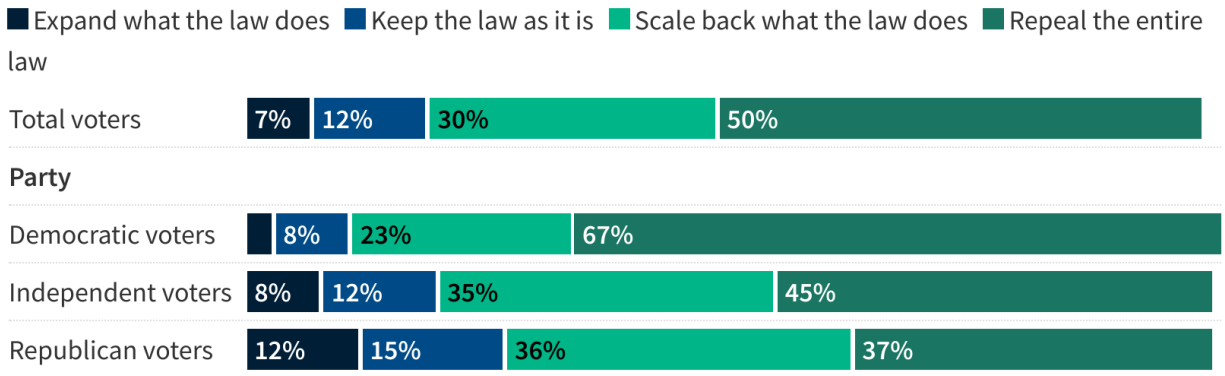
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While former President Trump recently stated he is not running to terminate the ACA, he has routinely criticized the law, saying he will make it “better” and “less expensive” and unsuccessfully pushed to repeal it during his time in office. A large majority of voters think Trump would try to either repeal the ACA (50%) or scale back what the law does (30%) if he is re-elected in 2024. About one in eight voters (12%) say they think he will keep the law as is and just 7% say they think he would try to expand what the law does. Despite the large share of Republican voters saying they would support repealing and replacing the ACA, Republican voters are less likely than Democratic voters to say they think Trump would attempt to repeal the entire ACA if elected in 2024 (37% v. 67%).

Figure 17

At Least Seven in Ten Across Partisans Believe Former President Trump Will Either Scale Back the ACA or Repeal It Entirely If Elected

If former President Donald Trump is elected as president in 2024, when it comes to the Affordable Care Act, or Obamacare, do you think he will try to… ?



Note: Among registered voters. See topline for full question wording.
Source: KFF Health Tracking Poll (April 23-May 1, 2024)

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Endnotes

[1] These were two separate items on a support or oppose list, not two separate answer choices to a single question.

May 2024 | Poll Finding

KFF Health Tracking Poll May 2024: The Public's Use and Views of GLP-1 Drugs

Alex Montero, Grace Sparks, Marley Presiado, Liz Hamel

Key Findings

- The latest KFF Health Tracking Poll finds that about one in eight adults (12%) say they have ever taken a GLP-1 agonist – an increasingly popular class of prescription drugs used for weight loss and to treat diabetes or prevent heart attacks or strokes for adults with heart disease – including 6% who say they are currently taking such a drug. The share who report ever taking these drugs rises to four in ten (43%) among adults who have been told by a doctor that they have diabetes, a quarter who have been told they have heart disease, and one in five (22%) who have been told by a doctor that they are overweight or obese in the past five years[1]. Public awareness of GLP-1 drugs has increased in the past year, with about one-third (32%) of adults now saying they have heard "a lot" about these drugs, up from 19% in July 2023.
- Most adults who have taken GLP-1 drugs say they took them to treat a chronic condition including diabetes or heart disease (62%), while about four in ten say they took them primarily to lose weight.
- About half (54%) of all adults who have taken GLP-1 drugs say it was difficult to afford the cost, including one in five (22%) who say it was "very difficult." While most insured adults who have taken these drugs say their insurance covered at least part of the cost, even among insured adults about half (53%) say the cost was difficult to afford[2].
- While 8% of adults ages 65 and older say they have taken a GLP-1 medication for a chronic condition, just 1% say they have ever taken a GLP-1 drug to lose weight, which may reflect Medicare's lack of coverage for prescription drugs used for weight loss. Nearly four in ten (37%) adults ages 65 and older report being told by a doctor they are overweight or obese in the past five years.
- With Medicare currently prohibited by law from covering prescription drugs used for weight loss, six in ten adults say they think Medicare should cover the cost of these drugs when prescribed for weight loss for people who are overweight, including more than half of Democrats, independents and Republicans. Similar shares of the public continue to support Medicare coverage of these drugs for weight loss even after hearing arguments for and against this proposal.

Use, Access and Affordability of GLP-1 Drugs

KFF's latest Health Tracking Poll examines the public's views and use of an increasingly popular group of drugs that include Ozempic, Wegovy, Mounjaro and others that belong to a class of prescription medications known as GLP-1 agonists[3]. GLP-1 drugs have garnered an increasing amount of media attention and some notable celebrity endorsements in the U.S., with much of the focus on their use for

weight loss, though many of these drugs are also prescribed to treat diabetes or reduce risk of heart attack or stroke.

A large and increasing share of the public say they have heard about GLP-1 drugs, with about eight in ten (82%) adults saying they have heard at least “a little” and about three in ten (32%) saying they have heard “a lot” about these drugs. The share of the public who report having heard about these drugs has increased since July 2023 when seven in ten adults reported having heard at least “a little” about these drugs and one in five (19%) said they had heard “a lot.”

The share who say they have heard “a lot” about these drugs rises to at least four in ten among those who have ever been told by a doctor that they have diabetes (45%) or heart disease (41%) or have been told by a doctor in the past five years that they are overweight or obese (42%) – the primary conditions these drugs are prescribed for.

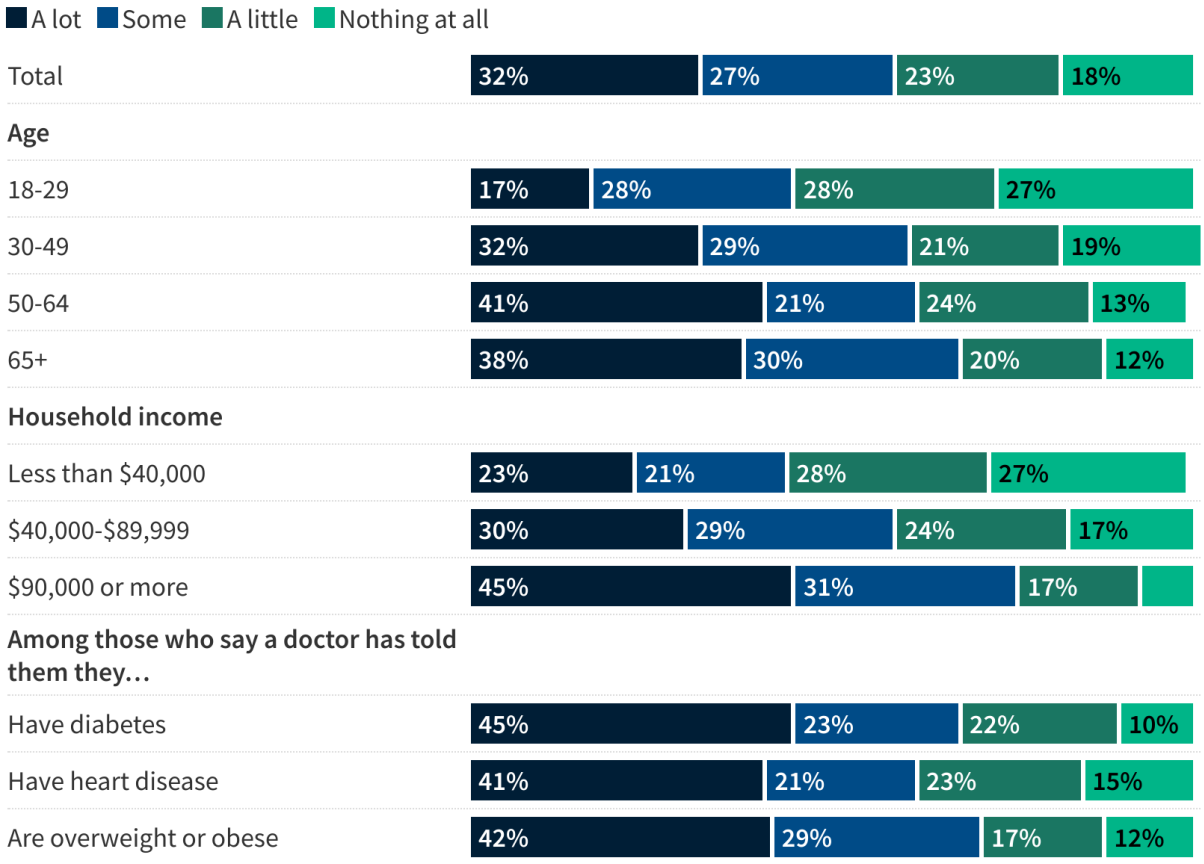
Across age groups, awareness of these drugs is highest among older adults. About four in ten adults ages 50 to 64 and 65 and older say they have heard “a lot” about GLP-1 drugs, compared to about one-third of adults ages 30-49 (32%) and one in six adults ages 18-29 (17%). Notably, older adults are more likely than their younger peers to have been told by a doctor that they have diabetes or heart disease.

Adults with annual household incomes of $90,000 or greater are more likely than those with lower household incomes to say they have heard “a lot” about these drugs.

Figure 1

Larger Shares of Older Adults and Those With Chronic Conditions Have Heard "A Lot" About GLP-1 Drugs

How much have you heard, if anything, about a class of drugs being used for weight loss, such as Ozempic, Wegovy, and Mounjaro?



Note: See topline for full question wording.
▶ Heart Disease and Diabetes Details
▶ Overweight or Obese Details
Source: KFF Health Tracking Poll (April 23-May 1, 2024)

KFF

Overall, 12% of adults say they have ever used GLP-1 drugs, including 6% who say they are currently using them. The share who report ever taking these drugs rises to about four in ten (43%) among adults who have been told by a doctor that they have diabetes, a quarter (26%) of adults who have been told they have heart disease, and one in five (22%) adults who have been told by a doctor that they are overweight or obese in the past five years (some of whom also have diabetes or heart disease).

Black adults are somewhat more likely than White adults to report ever taking these drugs (18% v. 10%), while 13% of Hispanic adults say they have taken these drugs. KFF's analysis of Centers for Disease Control (CDC) data shows that Black and Hispanic adults in the U.S. have a higher rate of obesity than

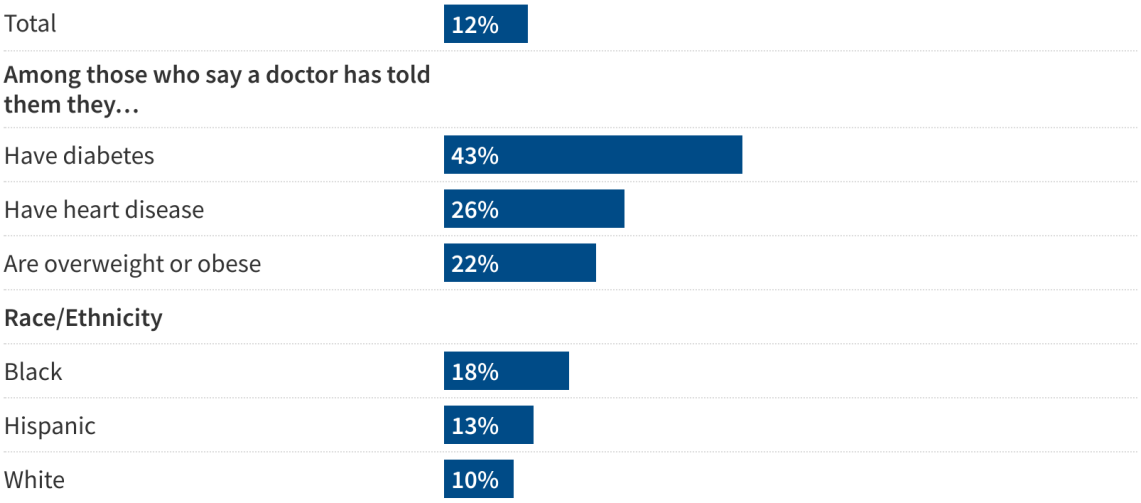
White adults. For additional information on obesity rates and racial disparities, see KFF's policy watch: What are the Implications of New Anti-Obesity Drugs for Racial Disparities?

Similar shares of adults regardless of gender, income, or health insurance coverage report taking these drugs.

Figure 2

One in Eight Adults Say They Have Ever Used GLP-1 Drugs, Rising to Four in Ten Among Adults Who Have Been Diagnosed With Diabetes

Percent who say they have ever used GLP-1 agonist drugs to lose weight or treat a chronic condition such as diabetes or heart disease:



Note: See topline for full question wording.
▶ GLP-1 Agonist Details
▶ Heart Disease and Diabetes Details
▶ Overweight or Obese Details

Source: KFF Health Tracking Poll (April 23-May 1, 2024)

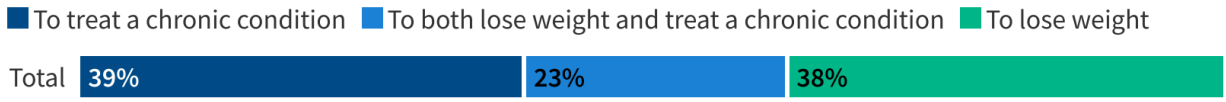
KFF

Among the 12% of adults who have ever taken GLP-1 drugs, most report taking them, at least in part, to treat a chronic condition like diabetes or heart disease, with fewer saying they took them only to lose weight. Among those who have taken these drugs, six in ten (62%) say they took them to treat a chronic condition like diabetes or heart disease, including about four in ten (39%) who took them only to treat a chronic condition and one in four (23%) who say they took them to both treat a chronic condition and to lose weight. About four in ten (38%) adults who have taken these drugs report using them only to lose weight.

Figure 3

Six in Ten of Those Who Have Ever Used GLP-1 Medications Did So To Treat a Chronic Condition Like Heart Disease or Diabetes

Do you take these drugs primarily to lose weight, or to treat a chronic condition like diabetes or heart disease, or both?



Note: Among those who have ever used GLP-1 agonists. See topline for full question wording.
Source: KFF Health Tracking Poll (April 23-May 1, 2024)

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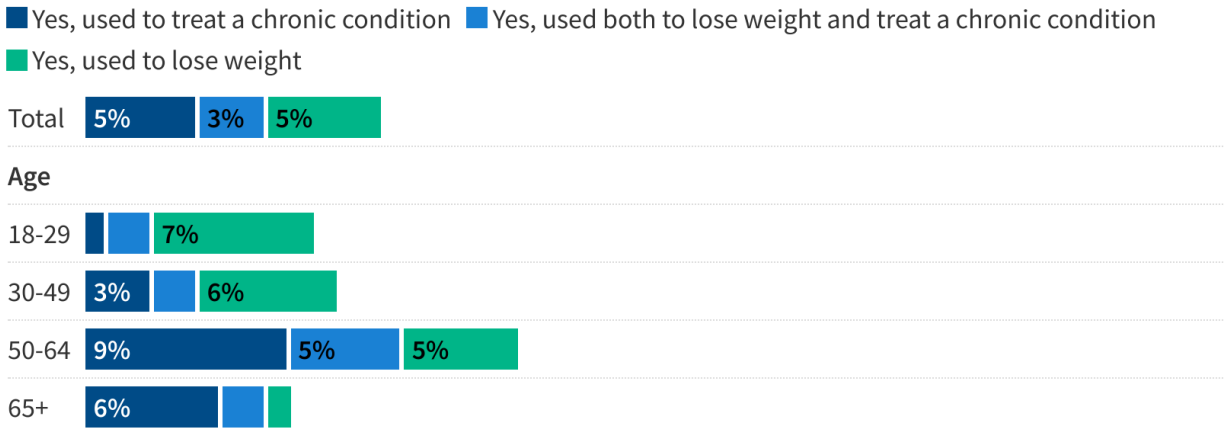
Among all adults, 7% say they have taken or are taking these drugs to treat a chronic condition such as diabetes or heart disease – either alone (5%) or in combination with intent of losing weight (3%) – while 5% of adults report ever taking these drugs to lose weight but not to treat a chronic condition.

About one in five (19%) adults ages 50-64 say they have ever taken GLP-1 drugs, higher than the shares reported by other age groups. Among adults ages 50-64, 15% say they have taken GLP-1 drugs to treat a chronic condition and 5% say they've taken them for weight loss only. Few adults under age 50 report having taken these drugs to treat chronic conditions, but similar shares of 18–29-year-olds (7%) and 30–49-year-olds (6%) report having taken them for weight loss. Among adults ages 65 and over, 8% say they have taken a GLP-1 medication for a chronic condition, while just 1% say they have taken these drugs only to lose weight, which may be a reflection of Medicare's lack of coverage for prescription drugs used for weight loss. Nearly four in ten (37%) adults ages 65 and older report being told by a doctor they are overweight or obese in the past five years.

Figure 4

Younger Adults Are More Likely Than Those 65 and Older to Report Taking GLP-1 Drugs Just for Weight Loss

Are you currently using or have you ever used a GLP-1 agonist to lose weight or treat a chronic condition such as diabetes or heart disease?



Note: See topline for full question wording.

▶ GLP-1 Agonist Details

Source: KFF Health Tracking Poll (April 23-May 1, 2024)

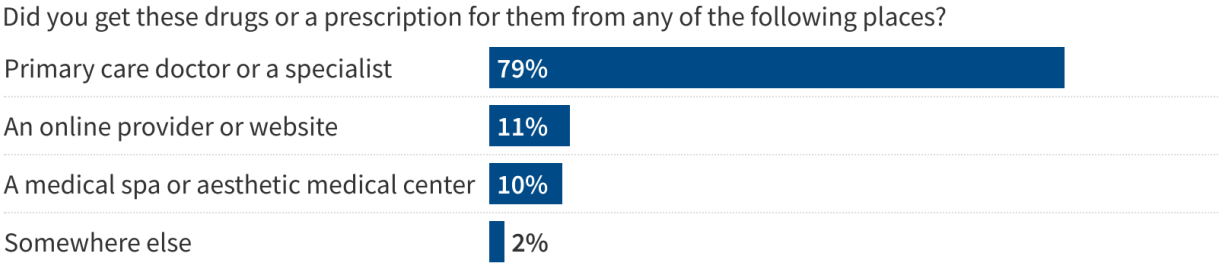
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Alongside the relatively high cost of GLP-1 drugs in the U.S., there have been recent reports of shortages or limited availability of these drugs occurring as demand increases. Recent news reports have emphasized that some adults are seeking generic or compounded versions of these drugs through sources such as medical spas or compounding pharmacies, which may sell products claiming to be name-brand GLP-1s that have not been vetted by the F.D.A.

About eight in ten (79%) adults who have taken GLP-1 drugs report getting these drugs or a prescription for them from their primary care doctor or a specialist, while fewer report getting them from an online provider or website (11%), a medical spa or aesthetic medical center (10%), or from somewhere else (2%).

Figure 5

Most Adults Who Have Taken GLP-1 Drugs Say They Got Them From Their Primary Doctor or Specialist, About One In Four Say They Got Them From Another Source



Note: Among those who have ever used GLP-1 agonists. Percentages will add up to more than 100 due to multiple responses. See topline for full question wording.

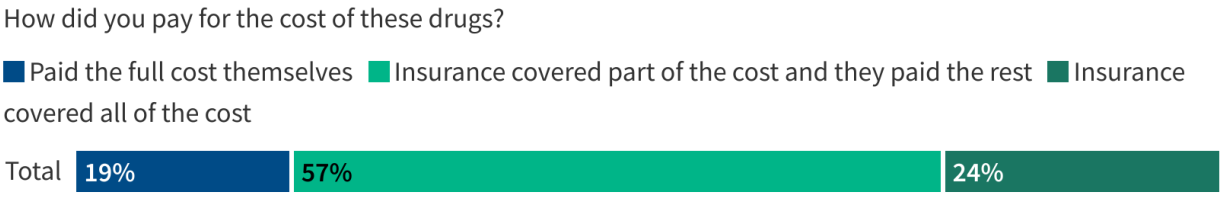
Source: KFF Health Tracking Poll (April 23-May 1, 2024)

KFF

In the U.S., list prices for GLP-1 drugs can range from $936 to $1,349 before insurance coverage, rebates or coupons. Most insured adults who have taken GLP-1 drugs say their insurance covered at least part of the cost. Among adults with health insurance who report ever taking these drugs, over half (57%) say their health insurance covered part of the cost of these drugs and they paid the rest, while one in four (24%) say their health insurance covered the full cost. One in five (19%) insured adults who have taken GLP-1s say they paid for the full cost themselves.

Figure 6

Most Insured Adults Who Have Taken GLP-1s Say Their Insurance Covered at Least Part of the Cost, but Fewer Say Their Insurance Covered All the Cost



Note: Among those who have ever used GLP-1 agonists who are covered by health insurance. See topline for full question wording.

Source: KFF Health Tracking Poll (April 23-May 1, 2024)

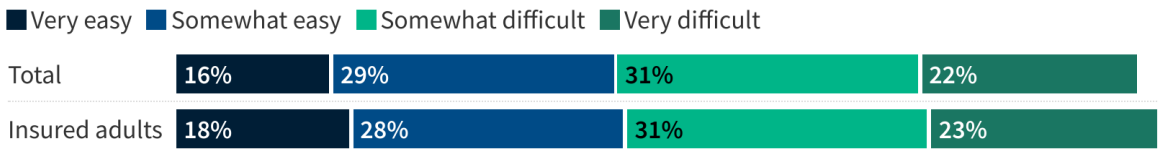
KFF

Despite the fact that few insured adults say they paid the full cost of these drugs themselves, many report difficulty affording them. About half of adults who have taken GLP-1s say it was difficult to afford the cost of these drugs. Among those who have taken these drugs, about half (54%) – including 53% of those with health insurance – say it was either “somewhat” or “very difficult” to afford to pay for these drugs, including one in five (22%) who say it was “very difficult,” including a similar share of adults with health insurance (23%).

Figure 7

Half of Adults, Including Similar Shares of Insured Adults, Say They Had Difficulty Paying for GLP-1 Drugs

How easy or difficult is it for you to afford to pay for these drugs?



Note: Among those who have ever used GLP-1 agonists. See topline for full question wording.
Source: KFF Health Tracking Poll (April 23-May 1, 2024)

KFF

Public Opinion on Medicare Coverage of GLP-1s for Weight Loss

While some Medicare drug plans cover the cost of some GLP-1s such as Ozempic or Wegovy when prescribed to treat diabetes or prevent heart attacks or strokes for adults with heart disease, Medicare is currently prohibited by law from covering drugs when prescribed for weight loss – for more information, see KFF's issue brief on Medicare coverage of GLP-1s. KFF's latest Health Tracking Poll finds that most adults think Medicare should cover the cost of these drugs when prescribed for weight loss for people who are overweight, with support remaining largely unchanged after hearing arguments for and against this proposal.

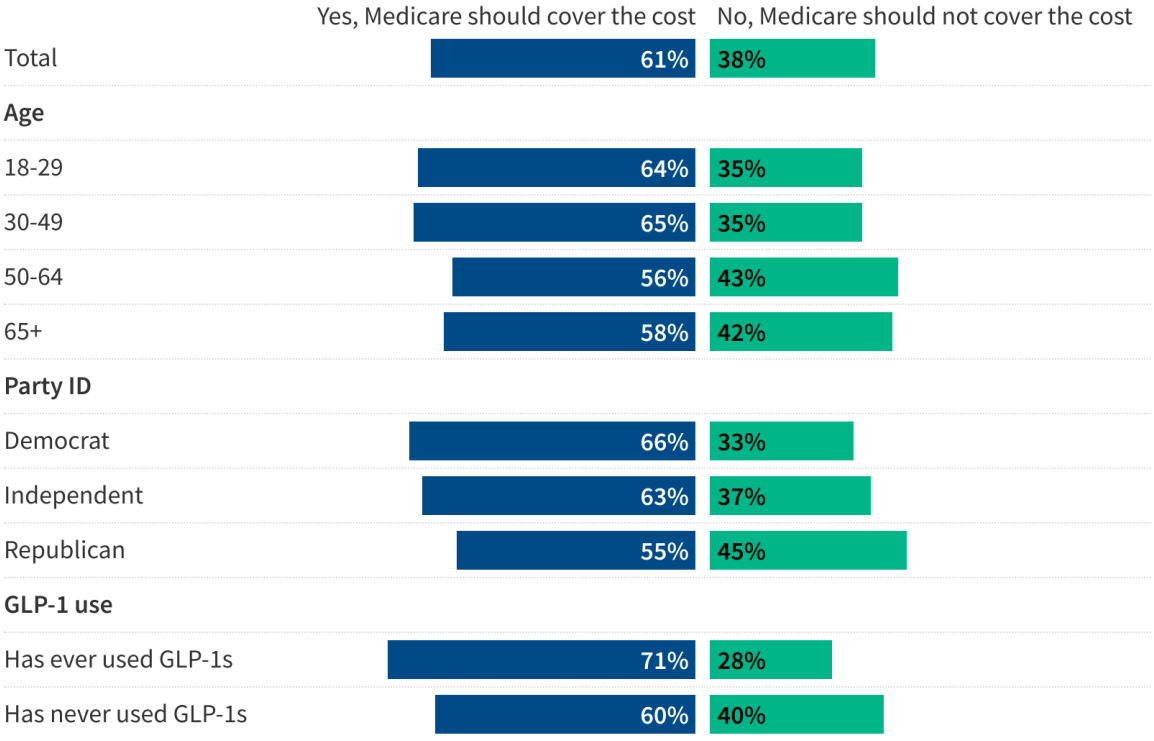
Overall, six in ten adults (61%), including similar shares across age groups, say they think Medicare should cover the cost of these drugs when prescribed for weight loss for people who are overweight, a share that rises to about seven in ten (71%) among those who have ever taken these drugs.

While more than half of adults across partisans say Medicare should cover the cost of these drugs for weight loss, Democrats (66%) are somewhat more likely than Republicans (55%) to say this.

Figure 8

Majorities Say Medicare Should Cover the Costs of GLP-1 Drugs for Weight Loss for People Who Are Overweight

As you may know, some Medicare plans currently cover the cost of some of these drugs when prescribed for diabetes or heart disease, but Medicare does not cover these or any other drugs when prescribed for weight loss. Do you think Medicare should cover the cost of these drugs when prescribed for weight loss for people who are overweight?



Note: See topline for full question wording.
Source: KFF Health Tracking Poll (April 23-May 1, 2024)

KFF

Attitudes on some policy proposals may change when the public hears different arguments in favor or against certain proposals. After asking whether Medicare should cover the cost of GLP-1s when prescribed for weight loss for people who are overweight, the poll presented two different arguments for and against this proposal:

Argument against: Some people say that if Medicare covers the cost of these drugs, it could increase premiums paid by people with Medicare and place financial pressure on the Medicare program and the federal budget.

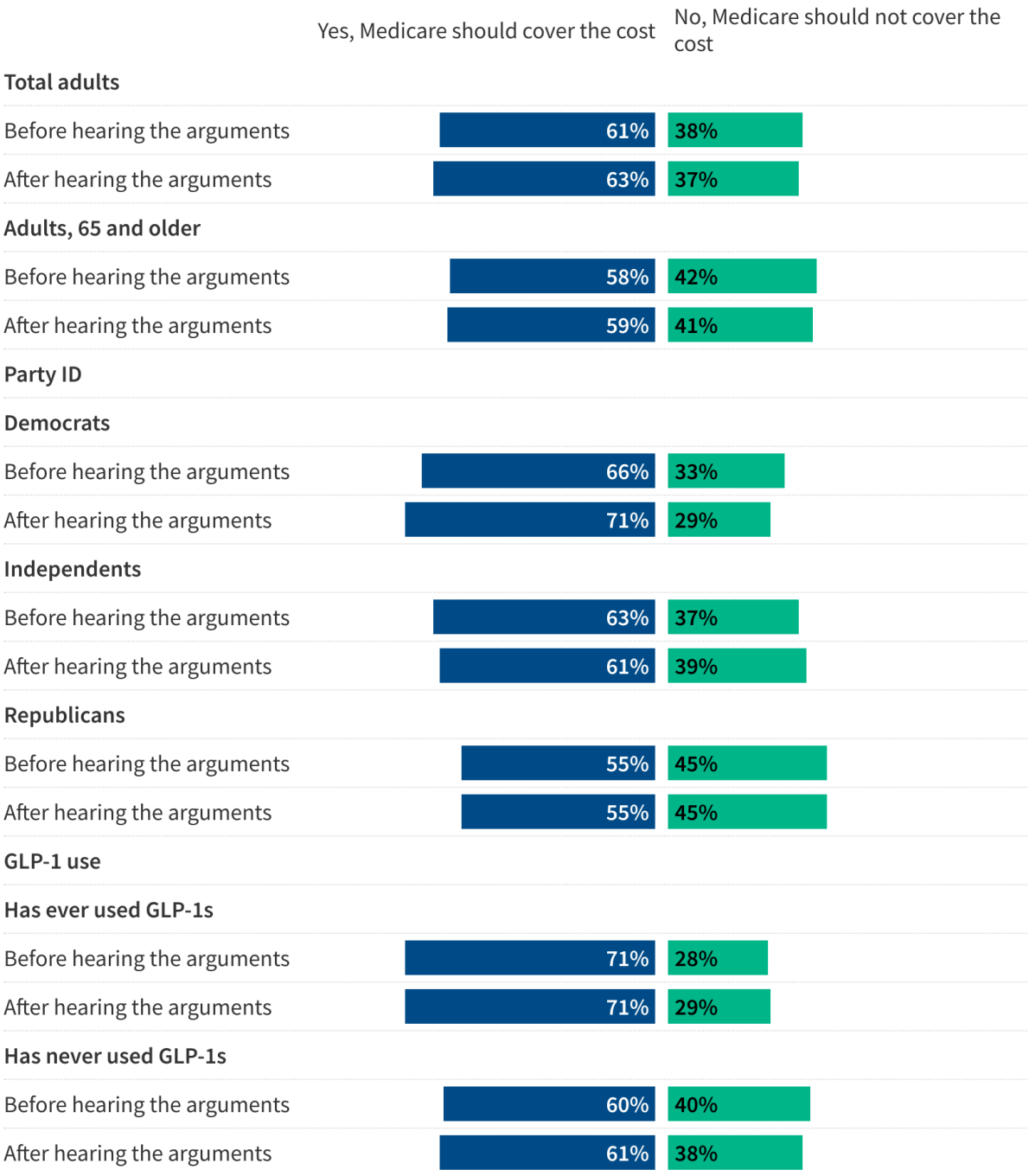
Argument in favor: Others say that if Medicare covers the cost of these drugs, it could help more people afford these medications and improve health and quality of life for people who are overweight.

After being presented with these arguments, the public's attitudes remain largely unchanged, with six in ten adults still saying they think Medicare should cover the cost of these drugs when prescribed for weight loss for people who are overweight. Attitudes also remained largely unchanged among adults 65 and older, among those who have taken GLP-1s and those who have not, and among independents and Republicans. Among Democrats, there is a slight increase in the share who say Medicare should cover the cost after hearing these arguments (71% after v. 66% before).

Figure 9

Opinion Regarding Medicare Coverage of GLP-1 Drugs Remains Largely Unchanged After Hearing Arguments on Both Sides of the Debate

Do you think Medicare should cover the costs of GLP-1 agonist drugs when prescribed for weight loss for people who are overweight?



Note: See topline for full question wording.
▶ Medicare GLP-1 Coverage Arguments
Source: KFF Health Tracking Poll (April 23-May 1, 2024)

KFF

Endnotes

[1] Adults who say a doctor or health care provider told them they are overweight or obese in the past five years include those who may also have diabetes or heart disease.

[2] Insufficient sample size to report among uninsured adults who have ever taken these drugs.

[3] These drugs are commonly prescribed for weight management, to treat type 2 diabetes, or to reduce the risk of heart attacks and stroke in people with cardiovascular disease. While Medicare is currently prohibited by law from covering medications used specifically for weight loss, Medicare spending on these drugs is currently skyrocketing given their high price and use for diabetes and to reduce cardiovascular risk. For more information, see KFF's policy watch on rising Medicare spending on Ozempic and other GLP-1 Drugs.

May 2024 | Poll Finding

KFF Health Misinformation Tracking Poll: Health and Election Issues on TikTok

Alex Montero, Grace Sparks, Marley Presiado, Liz Hamel

With the rise of social media use and growing concerns about health misinformation that accelerated during the COVID-19 pandemic, there has been increased attention to the role that various social media platforms play in the dissemination of health information, both accurate and inaccurate. Previous KFF polling has found that while few adults say they put a lot of trust in health information they come across on social media, those who use social media more frequently for health advice are more likely to believe false statements about issue like COVID-19 vaccines, reproductive health, and gun safety. This new KFF Health Misinformation Tracking Poll focuses on health and election-related information on the popular social media app TikTok in light of recent developments related to the platform.

In late April, President Joe Biden signed into a law a bill that would ban TikTok in the U.S. if its Chinese-owned parent company does not sell the platform within a year. The bill passed both chambers of Congress with bipartisan support, with many lawmakers, including President Biden, largely citing national security risks. At the same time, some media reports have documented the spread of various different types of health misinformation on the app, including misinformation related to prescription birth control.

Key Findings

- Most adults who use TikTok report seeing health-related content on the app, with the largest shares saying they've seen content about mental health (66%) and weight loss (66%). Younger users are particularly likely to report being exposed to health information on TikTok, with large shares of users ages 18-29 reporting seeing advice or information about several different health topics on the app, including mental health (91%), weight loss (79%), while many other younger users report seeing advice or information about abortion (59%), and birth control (52%).
- While about four in ten TikTok users say they trust information about health issues they see on the app, just one in eight say they have ever talked to a doctor (13%) or sought mental health treatment (12%) at least in part because of something they saw on TikTok. Larger shares of younger users ages 18-29 say they trust health information on TikTok (53%), and younger users are also more likely than older users to say they followed up with a doctor (19%) or sought mental health treatment (26%) due to content they've seen on the app.
- Most TikTok users say the content they've seen on the app has not affected their confidence in science and scientists, birth control, or vaccines. Overall, about one in seven users say content on TikTok has made them "less confident" (15%) in the safety and effectiveness of vaccines and a similar share (12%) say it has made them "more confident." Among Republican TikTok users, however, a larger share say

content on the app has made them “less confident” in vaccines (24%) rather than “more confident” (7%).

- When it comes to TikTok content centered on election issues, most users report either not seeing content related to these issues or seeing content that is a mix of different opinions on these topics. For the most part, TikTok users who identify as Democrats and Republicans report seeing a somewhat different mix of political content on the platform. On the issue of abortion, however, TikTok users across the political spectrum are much more likely to say the content they see on the app is mostly pro-choice or supportive or abortion rights rather than anti-abortion or supportive of abortion restrictions. Even among Republican TikTok users, the share who say they mostly see pro-choice content on the app is roughly three times the share who say they mostly see anti-abortion content (17% v. 5%).

TikTok Use and Exposure to Health Information

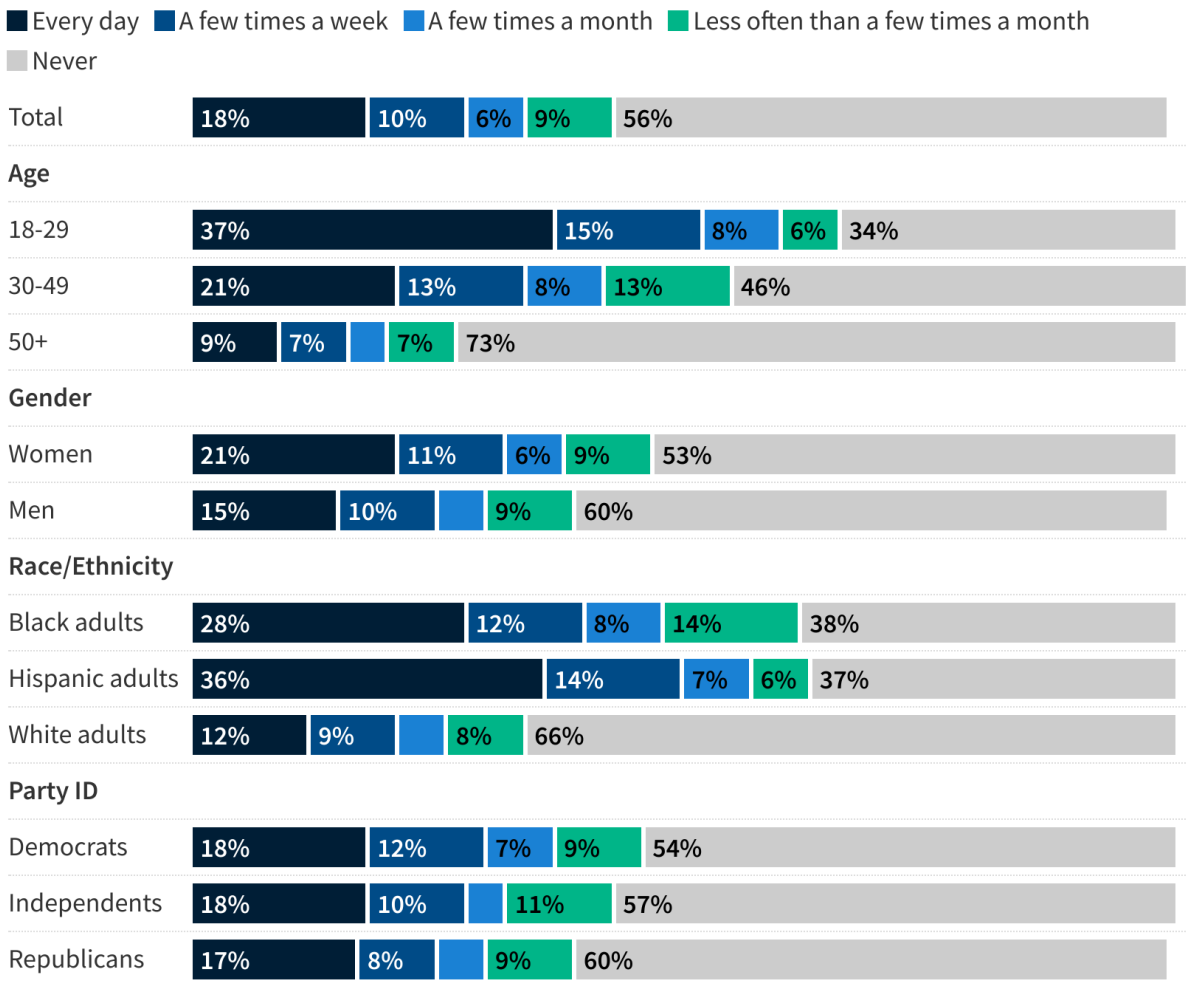
Just under half of adults say they use the social media app TikTok, including at least six in ten younger adults, Black adults, and Hispanic adults. About four in ten (44%) adults say they use TikTok, including larger shares of younger adults ages 18-29 (66%) and ages 30-49 (54%) and fewer adults ages 50 and older (27%). The app is more popular among people of color with about six in ten Hispanic adults (63%) and Black adults (62%) saying they use TikTok compared to about one-third of White adults (34%). Women are more likely than men to use say they use TikTok (47% v. 40%).

Similar shares – or at least four in ten – Democrats, independents and Republicans report using TikTok. About one in five adults (18%) report using the app every day, including nearly four in ten adults ages 18 to 29 (37%) and a similar share of Hispanic adults (36%).

Figure 1

One in Five Adults Say They Use TikTok Daily, with Use Highest Among Younger Adults, Black and Hispanic Adults, and Women

How often do you use the social media app TikTok?



Note: See topline for full question wording.
Source: KFF Health Tracking Poll (April 23-May 1, 2024)

KFF

Most TikTok users report seeing health-related content on the app, including a majority who say they've seen information or advice about mental health (66%) or weight loss (66%). About four in ten TikTok users say they've seen information or advice about vaccines (42%) on the platform, while about a third say the same about abortion (36%), prescription drugs (34%), and birth control (34%). Younger TikTok users are more likely than older users to say they've seen some of these topics on TikTok, with larger shares of users ages 18 to 29 saying they've seen information or advice about mental health (91%), weight loss (79%), abortion (59%), or birth control (52%). Women are more likely than men who use TikTok to say they have seen information or advice about mental health (71% v. 61%) or birth control (41% v. 25%) on the app. About half of women of reproductive age – or those ages 18 to 49 –

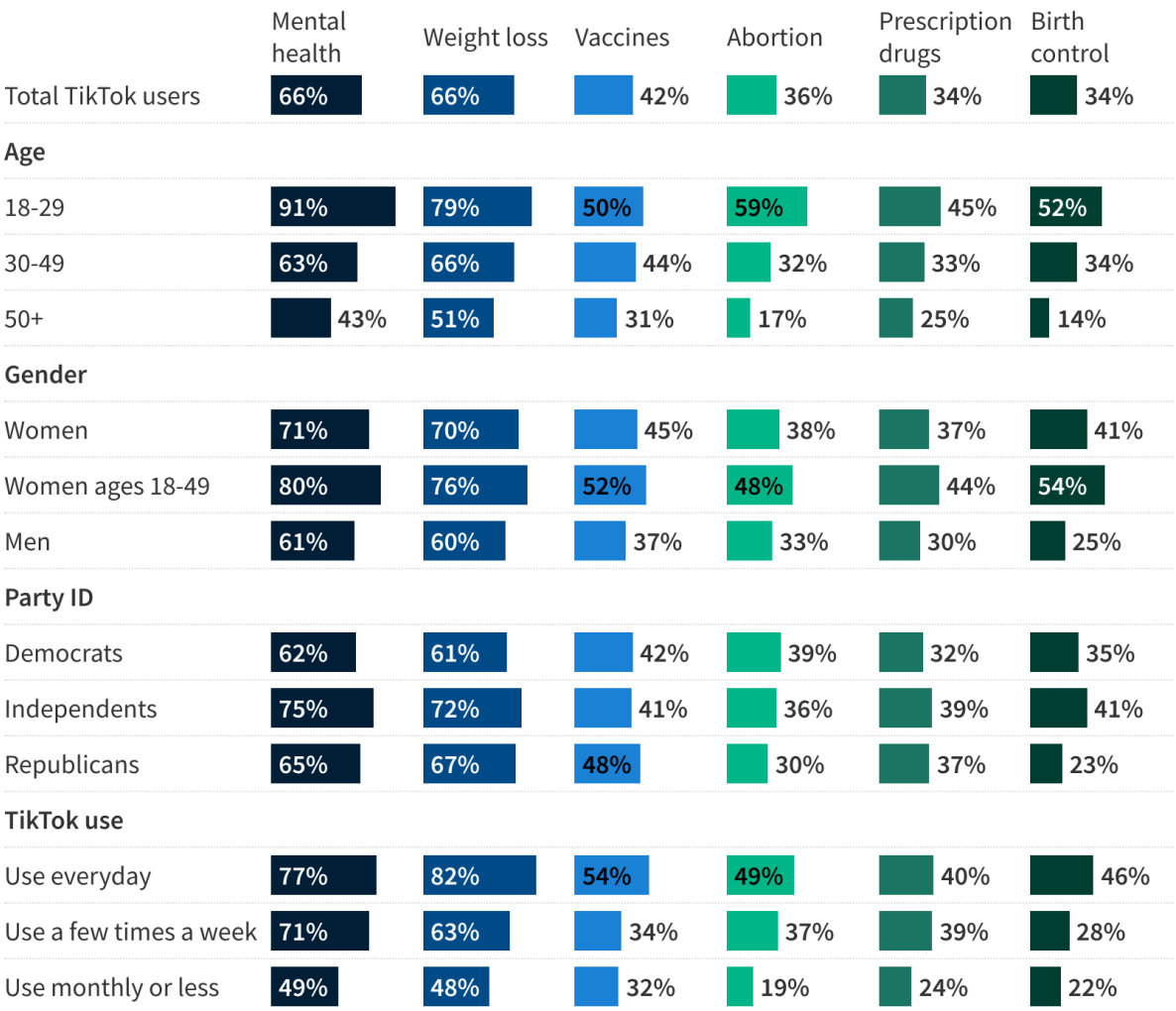
report seeing information or advice on TikTok about prescription birth control on (54%) or abortion (48%). Democrats (35%) and independents (41%) who use TikTok are more likely than Republican users (23%) to report seeing information or advice about birth control on the app; however, similar shares across partisans report seeing information about most of these other subjects.

Perhaps not surprisingly, there is a relationship between frequency of TikTok use and the amount of health-related content people report seeing on the app. Adults who use TikTok “every day” are more likely than those who use the app monthly or less often to say they’ve seen information or advice about each of the health-related topics included in the survey. Notably, larger shares of younger adults and women report using the app every day compared to older adults and men, respectively, which may at least partially explain why these groups report seeing more health-related content on the app.

Figure 2

Mental Health and Weight Loss Are Among the Top Health-Related Subjects TikTok Users Say They Have Seen Information or Advice About on the App

Percent who say they have ever seen information or advice about the following on TikTok:



Note: Among adults who use TikTok. See topline for full question wording.
Source: KFF Health Tracking Poll (April 23-May 1, 2024)

KFF

Trust and Conversations about Health Information on TikTok

Fewer than half of TikTok users say they trust information about health issues that they see on the app, but younger users, Black adults, and Hispanic adults report higher levels of trust. Overall, four in ten TikTok users say they trust information they see about health issues on TikTok at least "somewhat," including 9% who say they trust such information a "great deal." Most users say they trust health information on TikTok "not much" (36%) or "not at all" (23%).

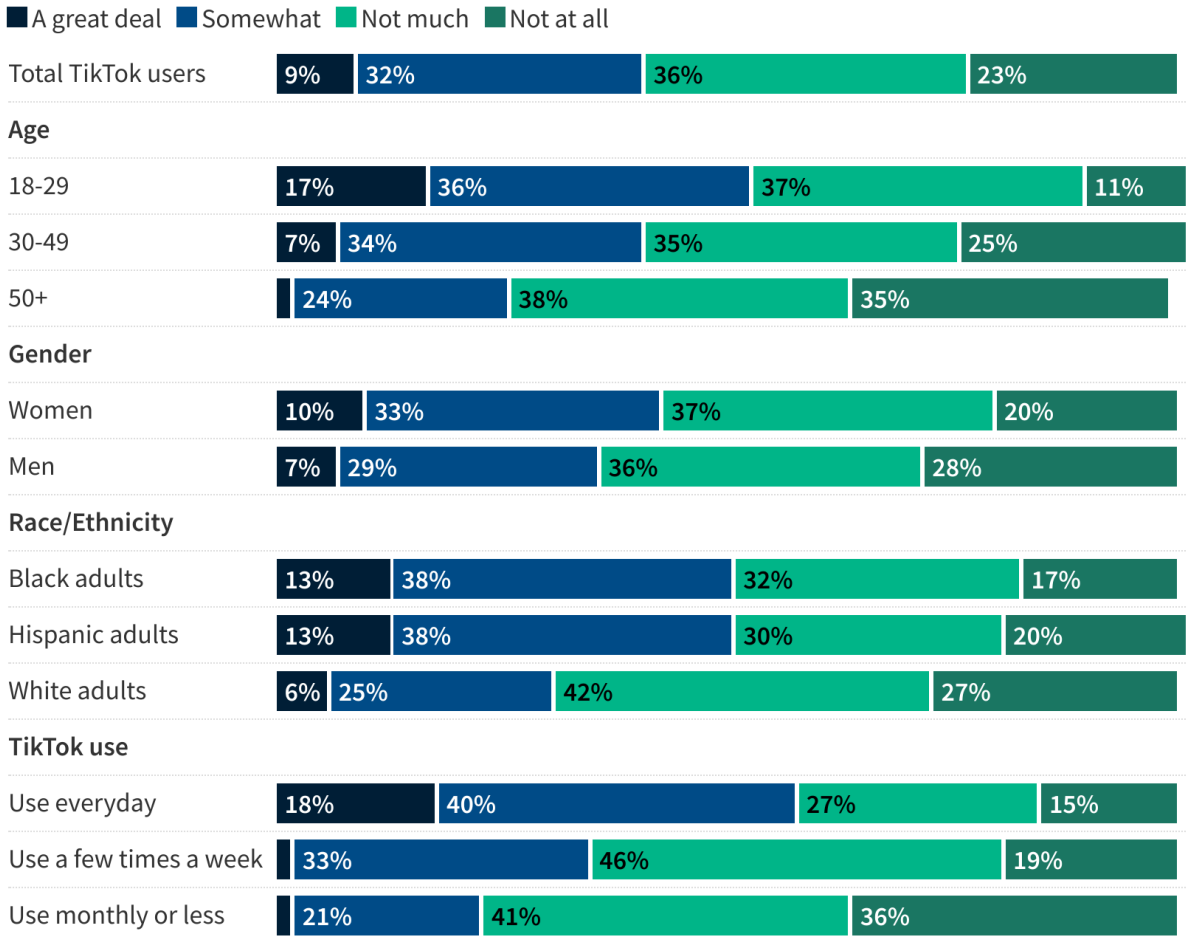
TikTok users between the ages of 18-29 are more likely than older adults to say they trust health information on TikTok, with about half (53%) of these younger adults saying they trust information about health issues on the app at least somewhat – including one in six (17%) who say they trust health information on TikTok “a great deal” – compared to smaller shares of older TikTok users. Similar shares of women and men who use TikTok say they trust information about health issues that they see on the app.

Among those who report using TikTok every day (18% of all adults), six in ten (58%) say they trust information about health issues they see on the app at least “somewhat.” Adults who use the app less frequently are less likely than daily users to report trusting health information they see on TikTok. Notably, daily TikTok users are disproportionately made up of younger adults ages 18 to 29.

Figure 3

About Four in Ten TikTok Users Say They Trust Health Information They See on the App, Including Larger Shares of Younger Users, Black or Hispanic Users, and Daily Users

How much do you trust information about health issues that you see on TikTok?



Note: Among adults who use TikTok. See topline for full question wording.
Source: KFF Health Tracking Poll (April 23-May 1, 2024)

KFF

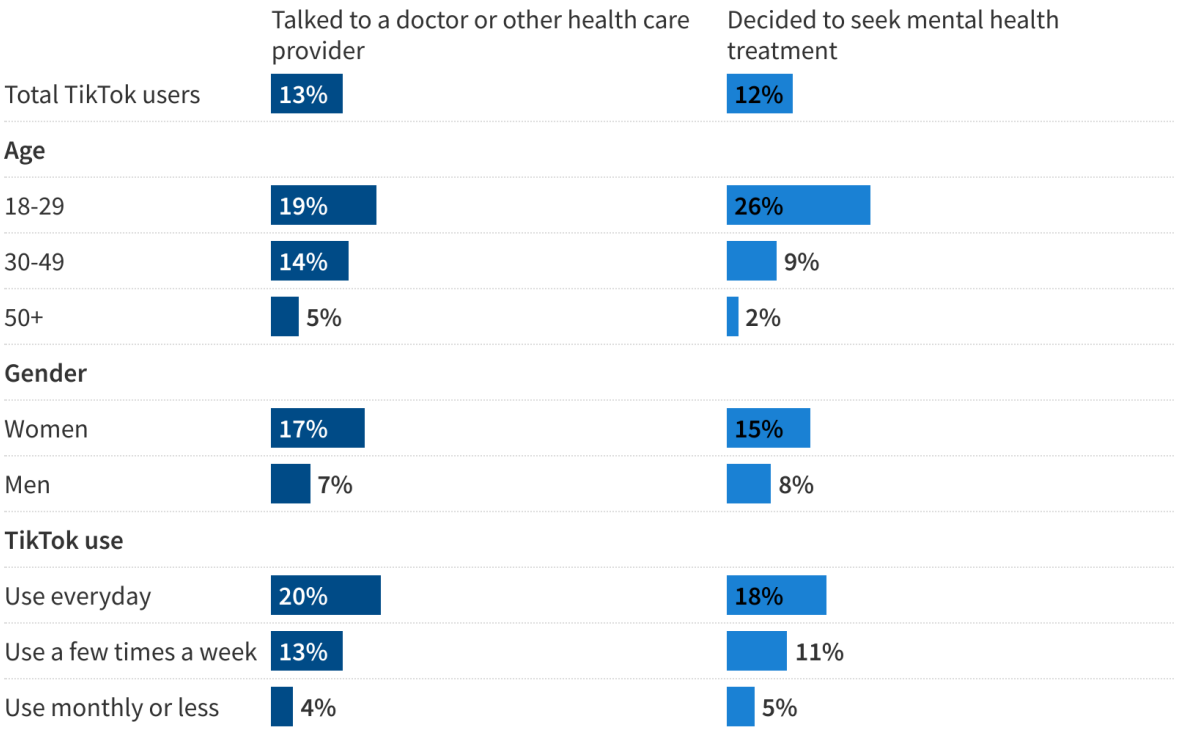
Few TikTok users overall and across demographics say they've talked to a doctor or sought mental health treatment because of something they saw on the app, but younger users and women are more likely than older users and men to report doing so. About one in eight adults who use TikTok say they have ever talked to a doctor or other health care provider at least in part because of something they saw on TikTok (13%) or decided to seek mental health treatment at least in part because of something they saw on the app (12%). Younger users are more likely than older adults to report either of these, with a quarter (26%) of TikTok users between the ages of 18 and 29 saying they decided to seek mental health treatment and one in five (19%) saying they talked to a doctor or health care provider because of something they saw on the app. Among TikTok users, women are about twice as likely as

men to say they talked to a doctor or health care provider (17% v. 7%) or decided to seek mental health treatment due to something they saw on the app (15% v. 8%). The share who report talking to a doctor or seeking mental health treatment at least partly because of something they saw on TikTok rises to about one in five among those who use TikTok every day (20% and 18%, respectively). Nonetheless, most of these daily users say they have *not* followed up with a doctor or sought mental menta health treatment due to content they've seen on the app.

Figure 4

Few TikTok Users Say They Have Ever Talked to a Doctor or Sought Mental Health Treatment Because of Something They Saw on the App

Percent who say they have ever done the following at least in part because of something they saw on TikTok:



Note: Among adults who use TikTok. See topline for full question wording.
Source: KFF Health Tracking Poll (April 23-May 1, 2024)

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While most TikTok users say content they've seen on the app has not affected their confidence in science and scientists, prescription birth control, or the safety and effectiveness of vaccines, users are more likely to say content on the app has made them more confident in science and scientists rather than less confident. At least seven in ten TikTok users say information they've seen on the app has not affected their confidence in the safety of prescription birth control (76%), the safety and effectiveness of vaccines (73%), or science and scientists (70%).

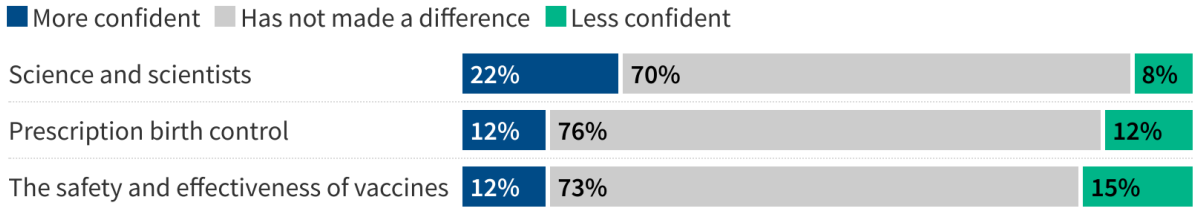
When it comes to trust in science and scientists, TikTok users are nearly three times as likely to say content they've seen on the app has made them *more* confident in science and scientists rather than less

confident (22% vs. 8%). By contrast, when it comes to confidence in prescription birth control and the safety and effectiveness of vaccines similar shares of TikTok users say content they've seen on the app has made them more confident as less confident (12% each for birth control, 12% and 15% for vaccines). Similar shares of women and men – including women of reproductive age under the age of 50 -- who use TikTok say content on the app has made them either more or less confident in prescription birth control, with about three in four saying it has not made a difference.

Figure 5

Most TikTok Users Say the App's Content Has Not Impacted Their Confidence in Science, Birth Control, or Vaccines

Has content you've seen on TikTok made you more confident or less confident in each of the following, or has it not made a difference?



Note: Among adults who use TikTok. See topline for full question wording.
Source: KFF Health Tracking Poll (April 23-May 1, 2024)

KFF

Most TikTok users across demographics say content on the app has not affected their confidence in the safety and effectiveness of vaccines, however Republicans are more likely to say TikTok content has made them less confident in vaccines rather than more confident. Overall, about one in seven users say content on TikTok has made them "less confident" (15%) in the safety and effectiveness of vaccines and a similar share (12%) say it has made them "more confident." For most groups across age, partisanship, race and ethnicity, the shares saying TikTok content increased their confidence in vaccines is similar to the share who say it decreased their confidence.

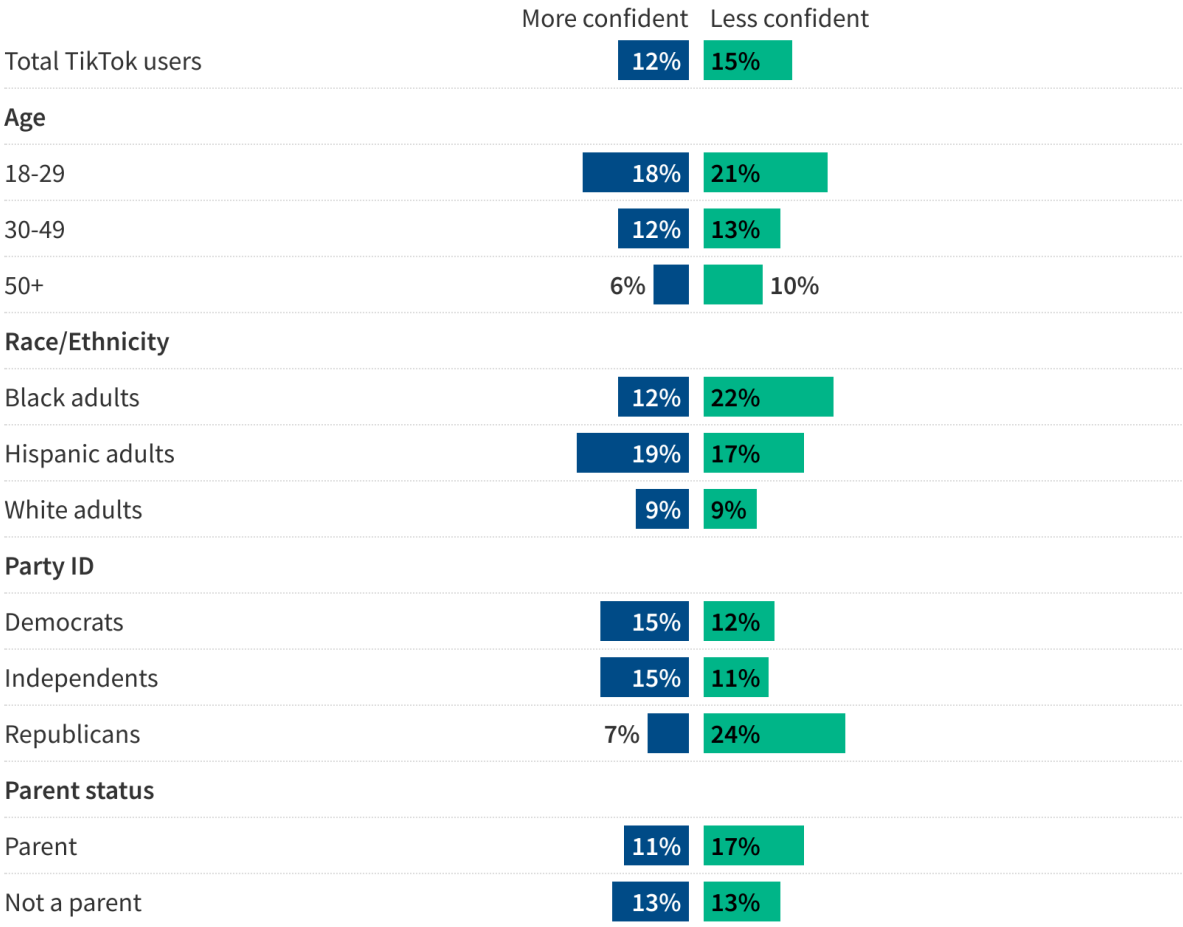
However, one group breaks with this pattern: Republican TikTok users are about three times as likely to say content on the app has made them "less confident" in the safety and effectiveness of vaccines rather than "more confident" (24% v. 7%).

Vaccine misinformation may affect parents' confidence in vaccinating their young children, and recent KFF polling has shown that about a quarter of parents report believing false information about measles vaccines. Just under one in five (17%) parents who use TikTok say content they've seen on the app has made them "less confident" in the safety and effectiveness of vaccines while a similar share of parents say it has made them "more confident" (11%). However, most parents who use TikTok say the content they've seen on the app hasn't affected their confidence in the safety and effectiveness of vaccines.

Figure 6

Republican TikTok Users Are More Likely to Say Content They've Seen on the App Has Made Them Less Confident in Vaccines

Has content you've seen on TikTok made you more confident or less confident in the safety and effectiveness of vaccines, or has it not made a difference?



Note: Among adults who use TikTok. Response option "Has not made a difference" excluded. See topline for full question wording.

Source: KFF Health Tracking Poll (April 23-May 1, 2024)

KFF

Election Issues on TikTok

As the 2024 presidential election approaches, TikTok users may be exposed to election-related topics and one-sided political discourse, particularly as growing shares of U.S. adults report regularly getting their news from the app. However, like other social media platforms, the content users see on their TikTok feeds may vary from person-to-person, as it is curated by the app's proprietary algorithm.

When it comes to TikTok content centered on some key election issues, including the presidential candidates, abortion, guns, and immigration, most users report either not seeing content related to these issues or seeing content that is a mix of different opinions on these topics. For the most part, TikTok

users who identify as Democrats and Republicans report seeing a somewhat different mix of political content, particularly when it comes to presidential candidates, but these patterns are not universal across the topics included in the survey.

It's important to note that this survey measures self-report views of TikTok content, which may not necessarily match up with other studies that look at actual content in users' video feeds.

Overall, few TikTok users report mostly seeing one-sided content related to the presidential candidates, but slightly larger shares say the content they see on the app is mostly pro-Donald Trump or anti-Joe Biden rather than mostly pro-Biden or anti-Trump, with even larger tilts toward pro-Trump or anti-Biden content among Republican users and young adults. The shares of TikTok users who say the content they see on the app is mostly Pro-Donald Trump or anti-Joe Biden (14%) is slightly higher than the share who say the content they see is mostly pro-Joe Biden or anti-Donald Trump (10%), with one in three (34%) saying the content they see is a mix of both viewpoints, and four in ten saying they don't see content related to either Trump or Biden on TikTok.

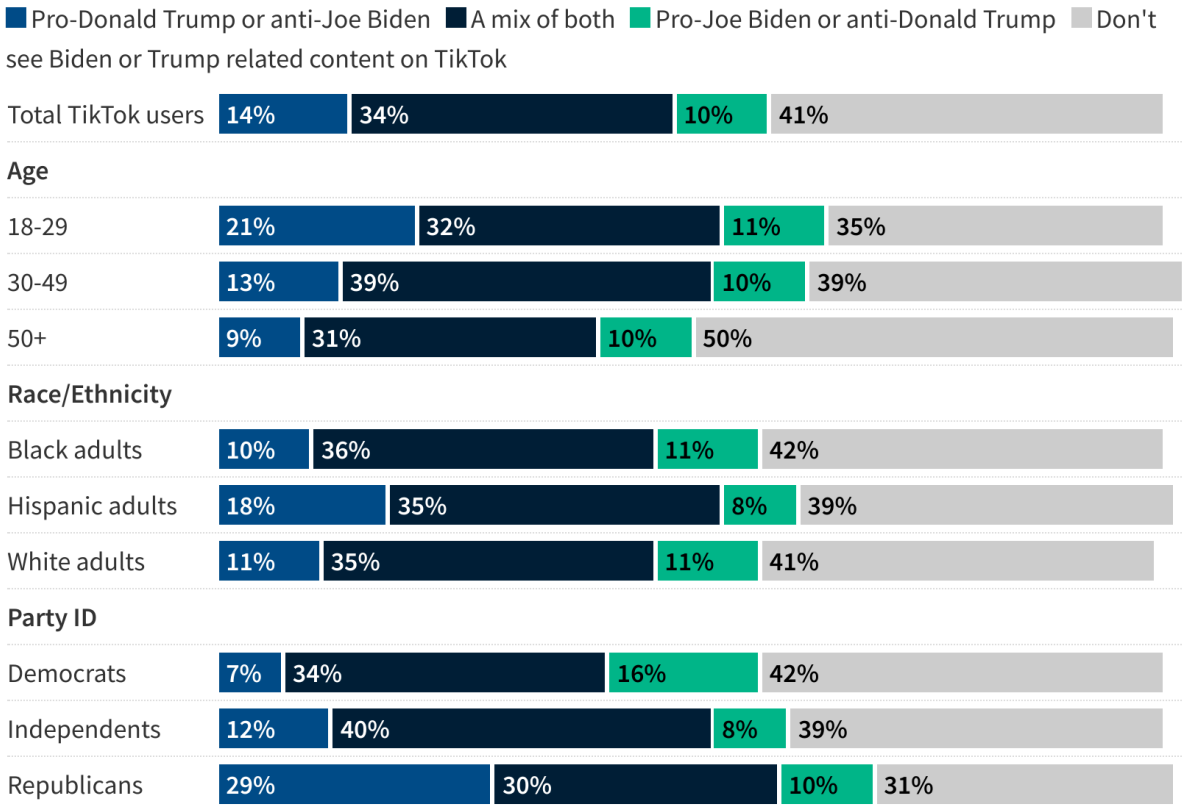
Perhaps not surprisingly, Republican TikTok users are about three times as likely to say the content they see is mostly pro-Trump/anti-Biden rather than pro-Biden/anti-Trump (29% v. 10%), while Democrats are about twice as likely to say the content they see mostly favors Biden rather than Trump (16% vs. 7%).

Notably, TikTok users ages 18 to 29 and Hispanic TikTok users are about twice as likely to say most of the content they see is pro-Trump or anti-Biden rather than pro-Biden or anti-Trump (21% vs. 11% for young users and 18% vs. 8% for Hispanic adults).

Figure 7

Younger TikTok Users and Republican Users Are More Likely to Report Seeing Pro-Trump or Anti-Biden Content on the App

Is the content you see on TikTok mostly pro-Donald Trump or anti-Joe Biden, pro-Joe Biden or anti-Donald Trump, a mix of both, or do you not see Biden or Trump related content on TikTok?



Note: Among adults who use TikTok. See topline for full question wording.
Source: KFF Health Tracking Poll (April 23-May 1, 2024)

KFF

Across partisanship and other demographics, the share of TikTok users who say the content they see on the app is mostly pro-choice or supportive of abortion rights (24%) is far larger than the share who say the content they see is mostly anti-abortion or supportive of abortion restrictions (4%). The share of TikTok users who say they mostly see pro-choice content rises to four in ten (42%) among those ages 18 to 29 – larger than the shares who say the same among those ages 30 to 49 (22%) and 50 and older (8%). These younger users are also more likely than older adults to report seeing *any* abortion-related content on TikTok.

Few users across partisan groups (including just 5% of Republicans) report seeing mostly anti-abortion content on TikTok, though Democrats who use TikTok are more likely than Republican users to say the content they see is mostly pro-choice of supportive of abortion rights (32% v. 17%).

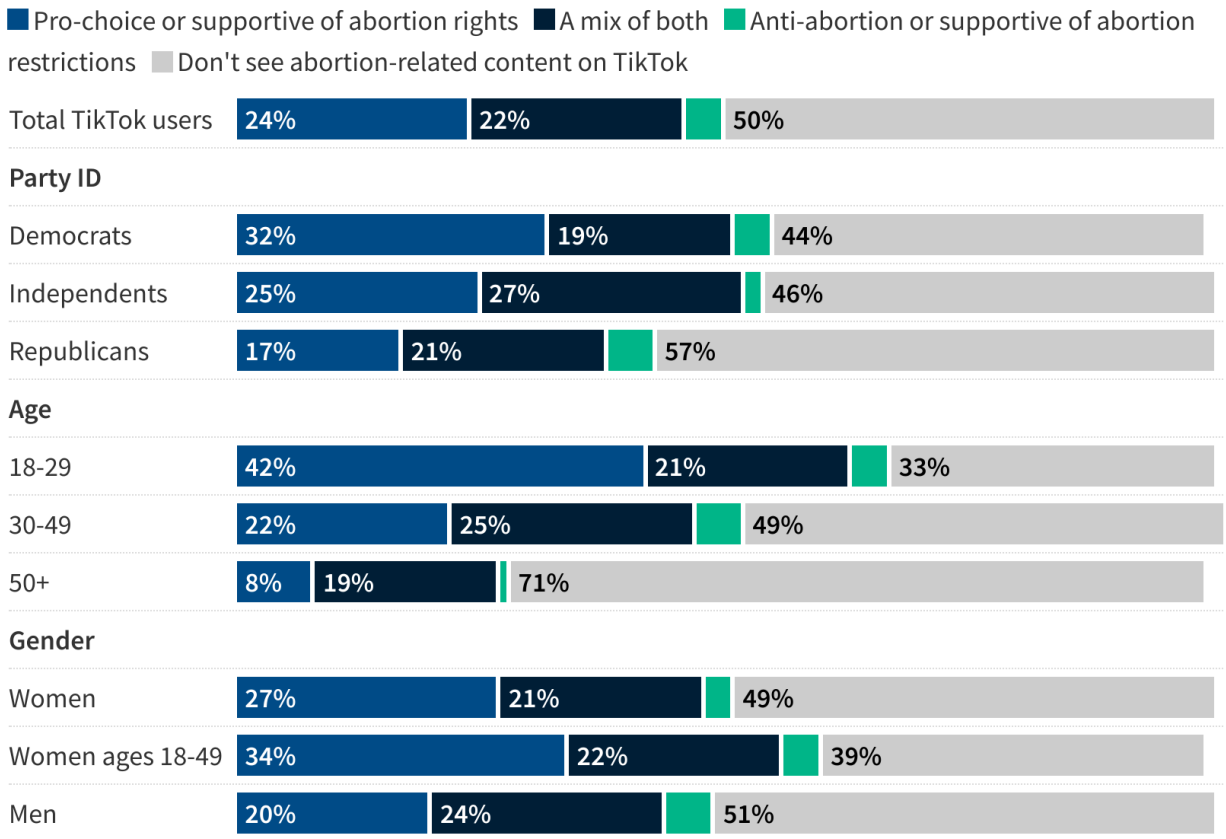
Overall, men and women who use TikTok are each much more likely to report seeing mostly pro-choice content than to say they see mostly anti-abortion content. While about three in four (27%) women who use TikTok say the content they see is mostly pro-choice, this rises to about one-third (34%) among women ages 18 to 49.

Despite these differences, most users – including at least half across partisanship, age, and gender – say the content they see related to abortion on TikTok is either a mix of both pro and anti-abortion viewpoints (22%) or they don't see this content related to abortion at all (50%).

Figure 8

TikTok Users Across Demographics Are More Likely to Report Seeing Content on the App That Is Mostly Pro-Choice or Supportive of Abortion Rights

Is the content you see on TikTok mostly pro-choice or supportive of abortion rights, mostly anti-abortion or supportive of abortion restrictions, a mix of both, or do you not see abortion-related content on TikTok?



Note: Among adults who use TikTok. See topline for full question wording.
Source: KFF Health Tracking Poll (April 23-May 1, 2024)

KFF

Most TikTok users who report seeing gun-related content on the app say they see a mix of viewpoints, but Democrats and younger users are more likely to report seeing mostly anti-gun content. One quarter of TikTok users say they see a mix of gun-related viewpoints on the app, while

about one in ten each say they mostly see pro-gun content (8%) or anti-gun content (10%) and over half (57%) report not seeing gun-related content on TikTok.

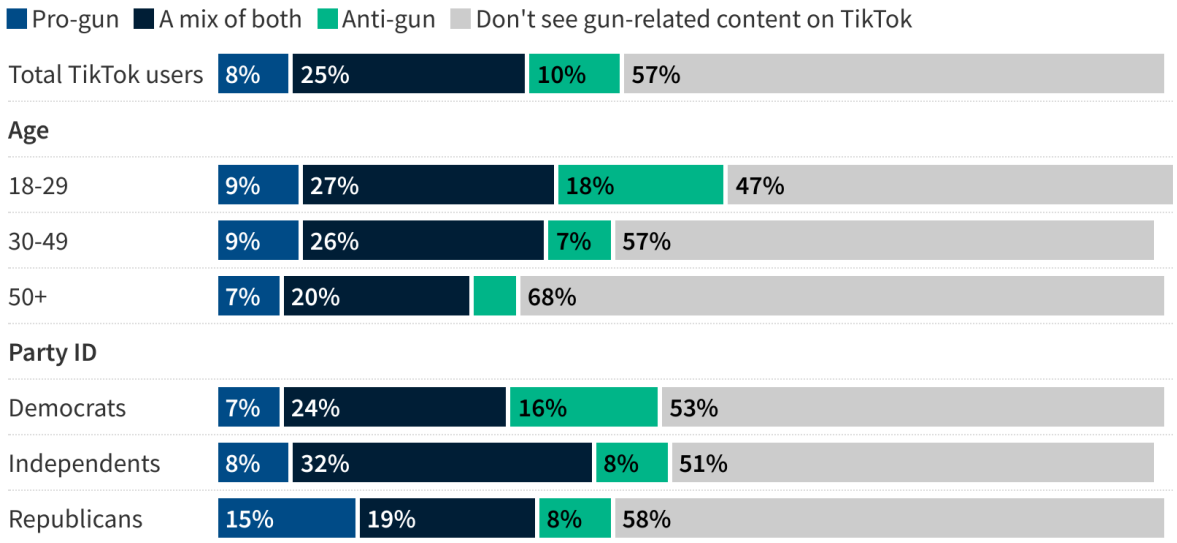
Democrats who use TikTok are about twice as likely to say they mostly see anti-gun content as opposed to pro-gun content on the app (16% v. 7%). Younger TikTok users ages 18 to 29 are about twice as likely to say they mostly see anti-gun content than pro-gun content (18% v. 9%), while other age groups report seeing either viewpoint in similar shares.

Among all TikTok users, and across these demographic groups, most users say the content they see is either a mix of both pro and anti-gun or say they do not see gun-related content on the app.

Figure 9

Most TikTok Users Who See Gun-Related Content Report Seeing a Mix of Viewpoints, but Democrats and Younger Users Are More Likely to See Anti-Gun Content

Is the content you see on TikTok mostly pro-gun, mostly anti-gun, a mix of both, or do you not see gun-related content on TikTok?



Note: Among adults who use TikTok. See topline for full question wording.
Source: KFF Health Tracking Poll (April 23-May 1, 2024)

KFF

TikTok users report seeing a mix of immigration-related content on the app, with no clear differences by partisanship. For immigration-related content, somewhat larger shares of TikTok users say the content they see is mostly pro-immigration (15%) compared to those who say they mostly see anti-immigration content (10%). Most users, however, say the content they see is either a mix of both pro and anti-immigration viewpoints (27%) or they don't see this content on TikTok (47%). Despite often bitter partisan debates over the country's approach to immigration policy (an issue that has ranked high among voters' top issues ahead the 2024 election) among Democrats, independents and Republicans who use

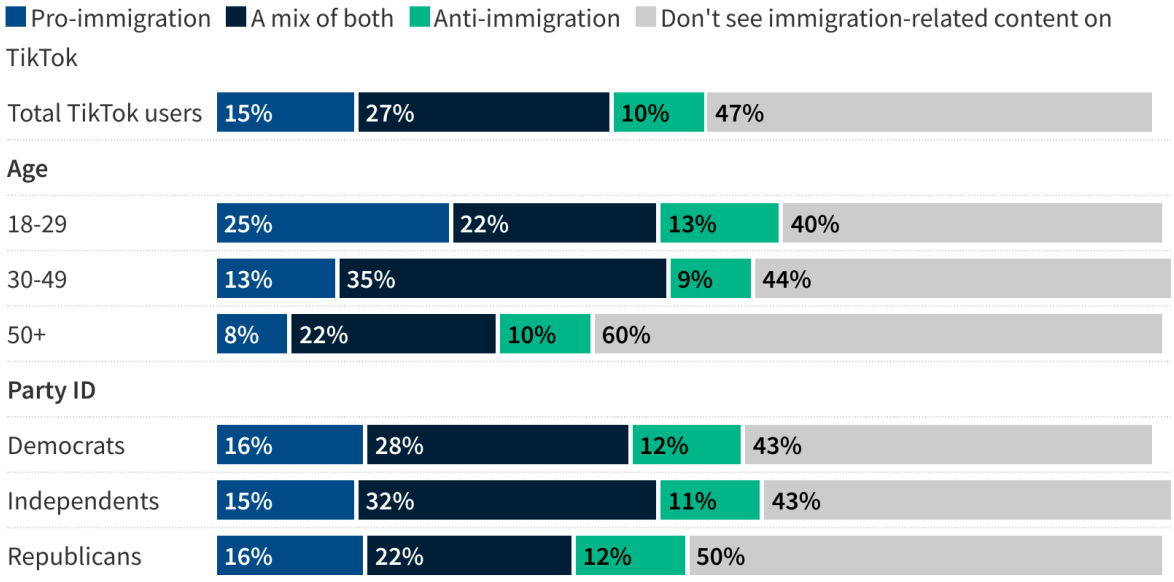
TikTok, similar shares say the content they see on the app is either mostly pro-immigration or anti-immigration, with at least one in five across these groups saying they see a mix of viewpoints.

Younger TikTok users ages 18 to 29 are about twice as likely to say the content they see on the app is mostly pro-immigration rather than anti-immigration (25% v. 13%), but among older age groups, similar shares report seeing either mostly pro-immigration content or mostly anti- immigration content.

Figure 10

While About Half of TikTok Users Report Seeing Immigration Content on the App, Relatively Few Say the Content Is Mostly One-Sided

Is the content you see on TikTok mostly pro-immigration, mostly anti-immigration, a mix of both, or do you not see immigration-related content on TikTok?



Note: Among adults who use TikTok. See topline for full question wording.
Source: KFF Health Tracking Poll (April 23-May 1, 2024)

KFF